Young Women's Labour-Market Inclusion

Findings and cost of inaction, Ukraine

Hernando Grueso, PhD · UNICEF

2026-11-01

Content

1 · The problem: NEET among young women

2 · Who is most affected

3 · From education to earnings

4 · The cost of the gender gap

5 · Conclusions and recommendations

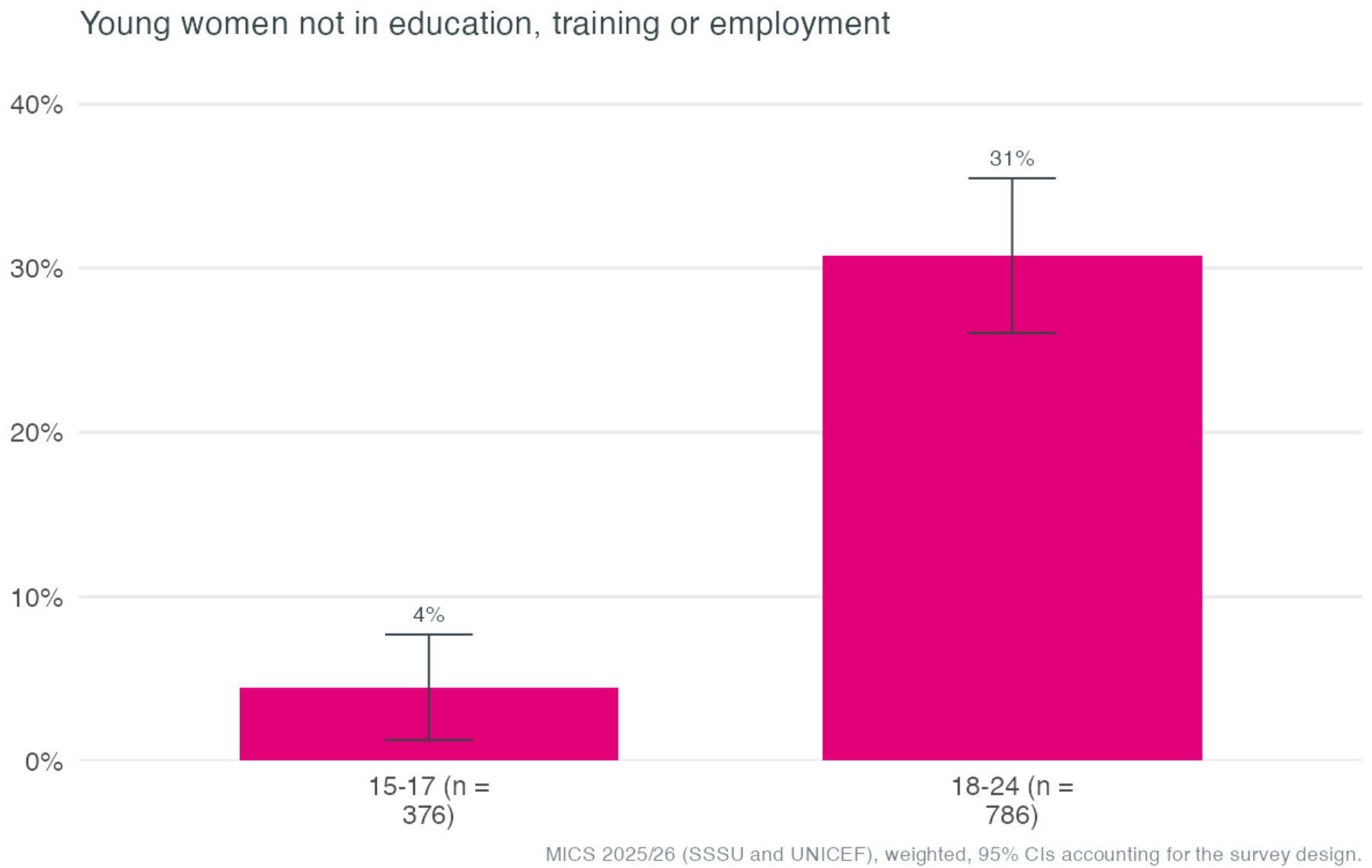
Appendix

Data sources

- **Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) 2025/26**, State Statistics Service of Ukraine with UNICEF: 23,708 households, 37,315 household members, 8,213 women aged 15–49 selected for interview, and children 5–17. There is no men's questionnaire. Main source for education, NEET and employment among young women, marriage, motherhood, disability, displacement, wealth and changes in households since the beginning of the conflict.
- **UNICEF Household Social and Economic Status Survey (HSESS)**, December 2023 to February 2024, Institute of Demography and Quality of Life Problems: 18,838 individuals in 8,024 households, all regions covered by the survey (Luhansk oblast is not included). Covers women and men: participation, employment, NEET, job quality, occupations, earnings and childcare.
- **SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021** (anonymised public-use file), collected in 2021: 265.6k interviews from 151.7k persons aged 15+. Shown for reference only.

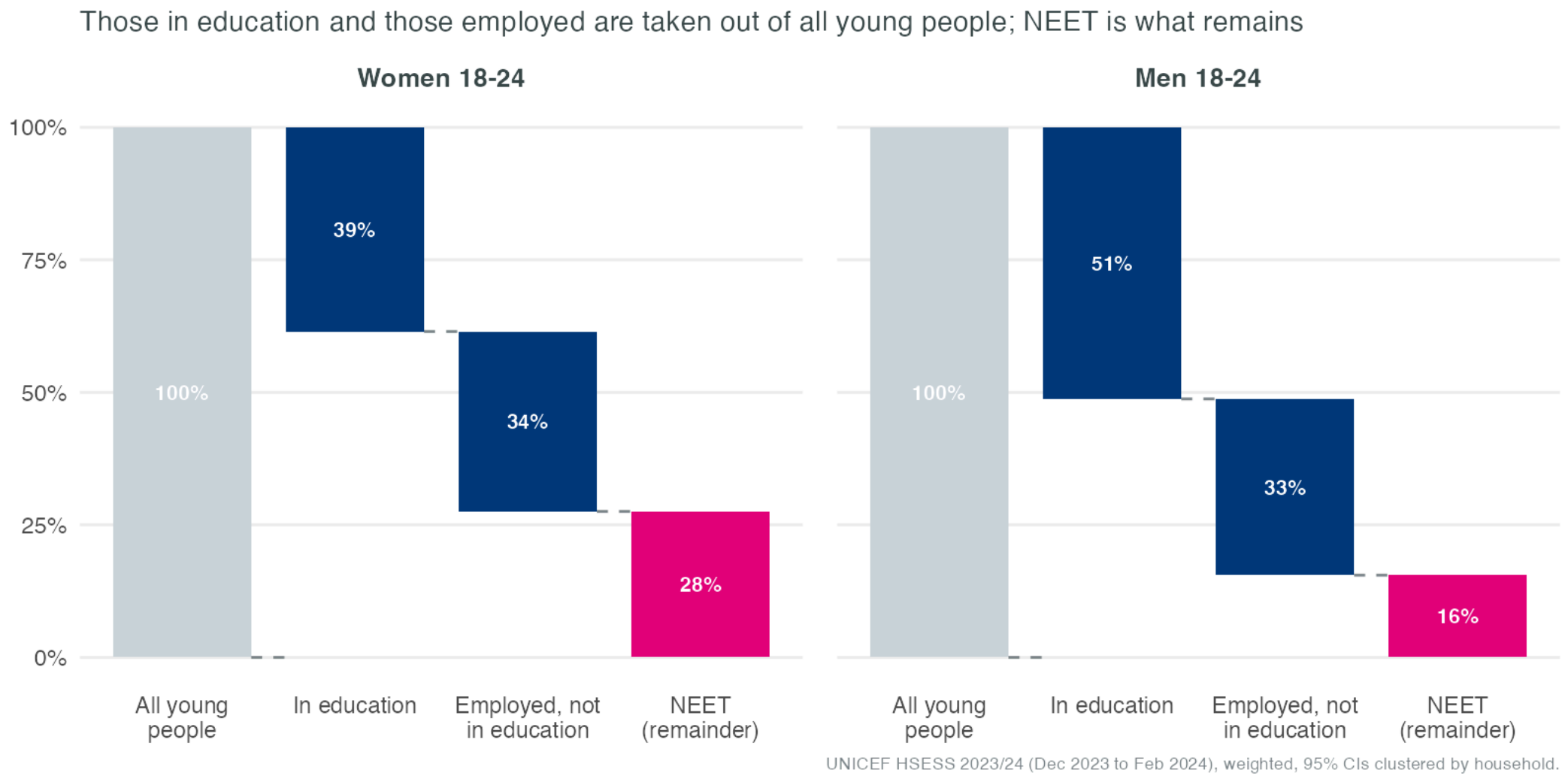
1 · The problem

31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET



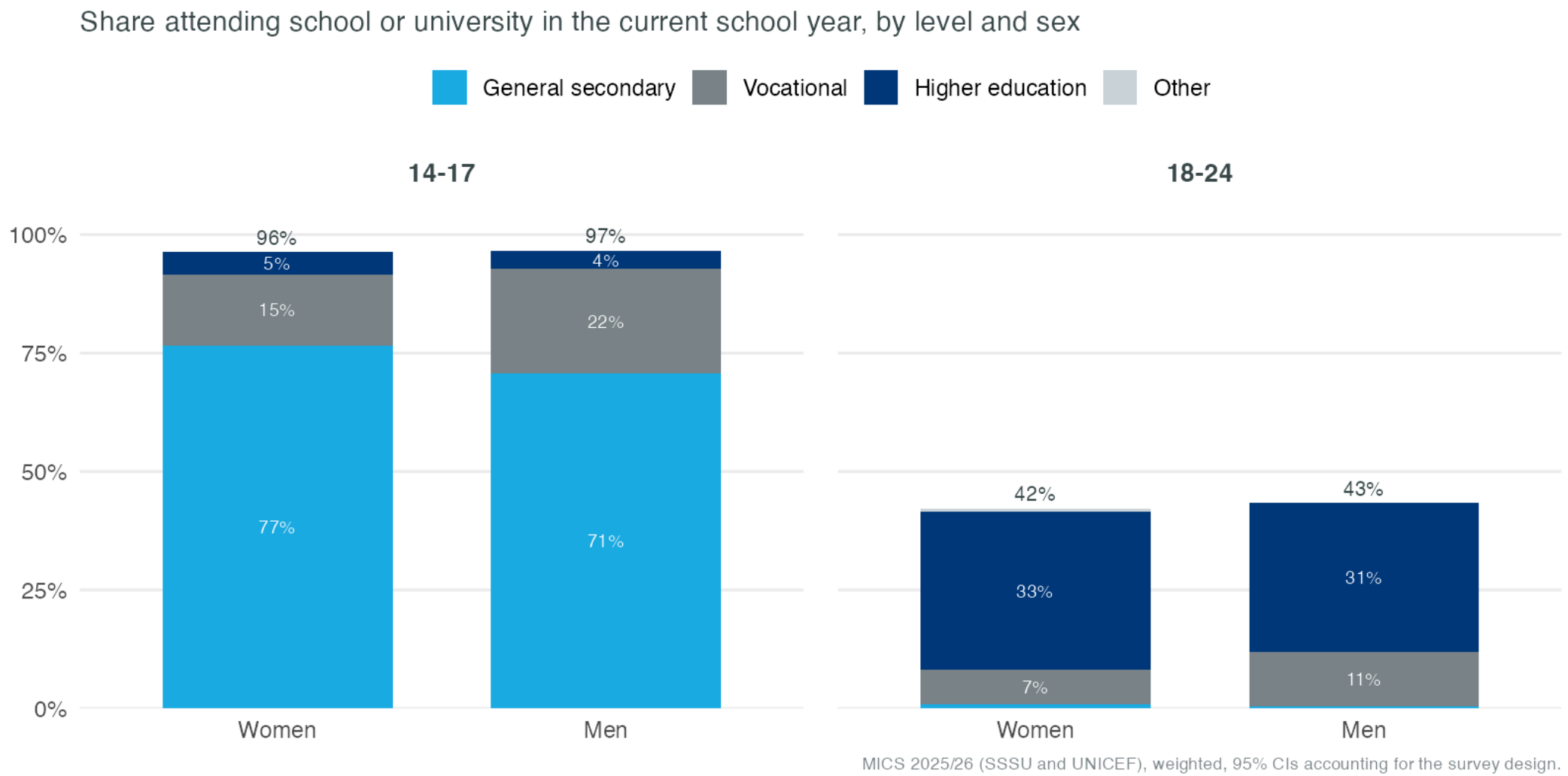
MICS 2025/26. NEET: not in education or training and not employed. At 15–17 the rate is 4%: almost all girls are still in education. The survey asks these questions to women from age 15, so NEET cannot be measured at 14.

The gap with young men comes from education, not employment



HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24. NEET: women 28%, men 16%. In education: women 38%, men 51%. Employed and not in education: women 34%, men 33%. NEET is what remains after education and employment.

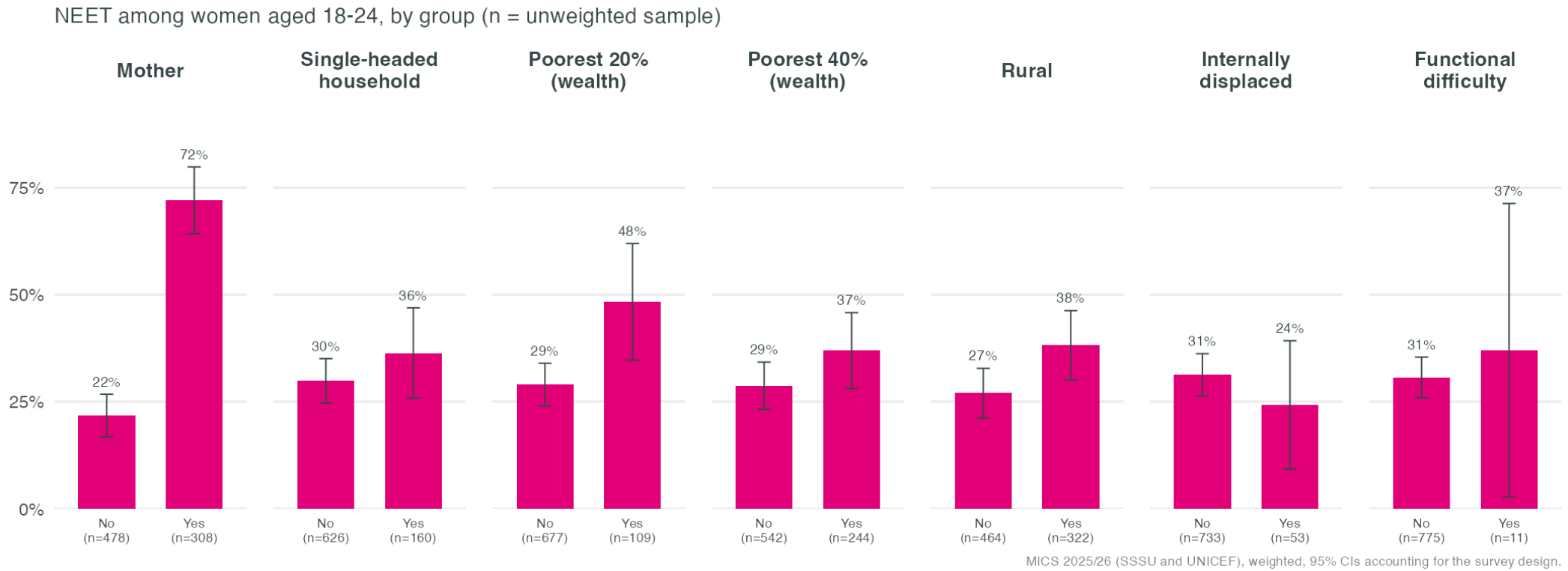
At 14–17, almost all girls and boys are in school



MICS 2025/26, household members attending in the current school year. Ages 14–17: girls 96%, boys 97%. Ages 18–24: women 42%, men 43%. School attendance is available from age 14; NEET and employment only from age 15. MICS does not show the gap in education at 18–24 that HSESS shows; the surveys differ in date, respondent and definition.

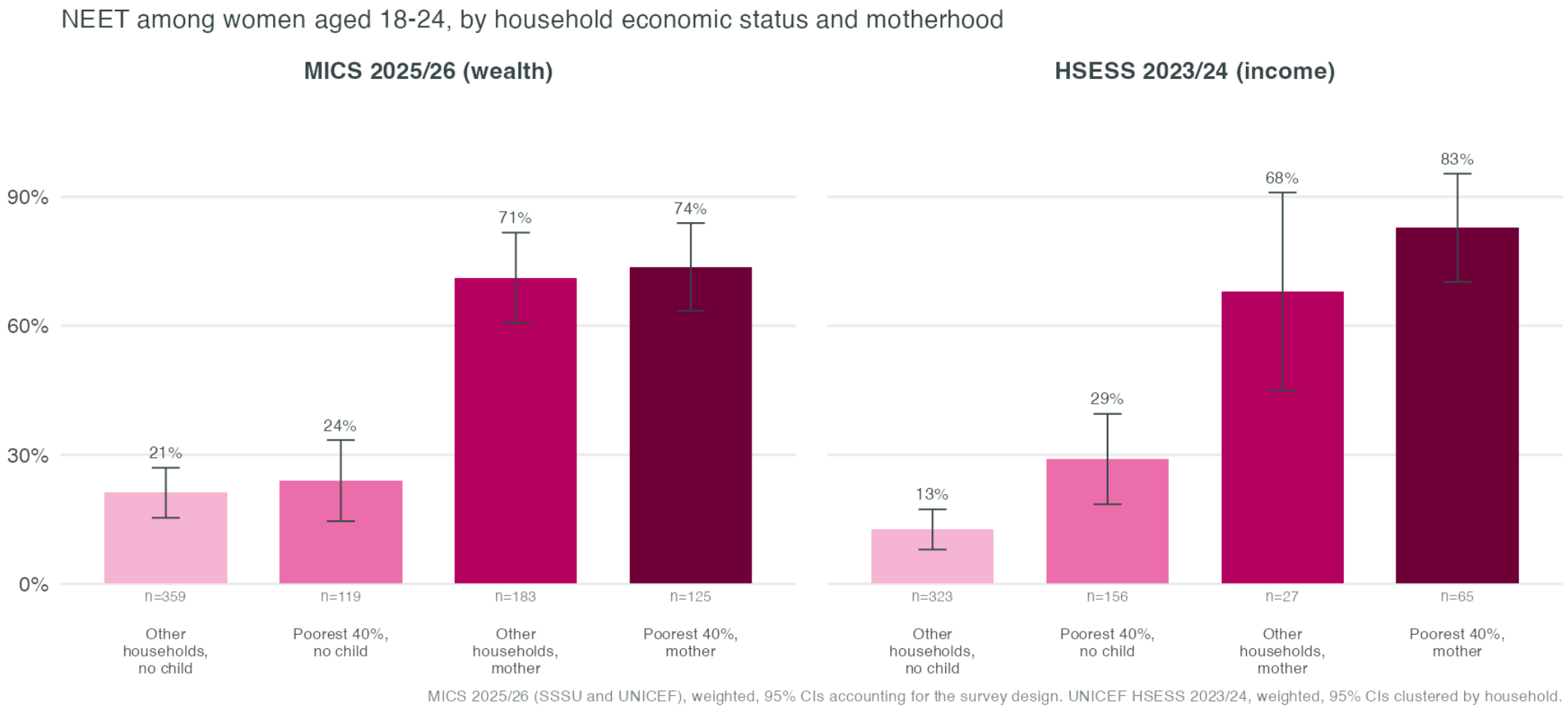
2 · Who is most affected

Mothers and the poorest have the highest NEET rates



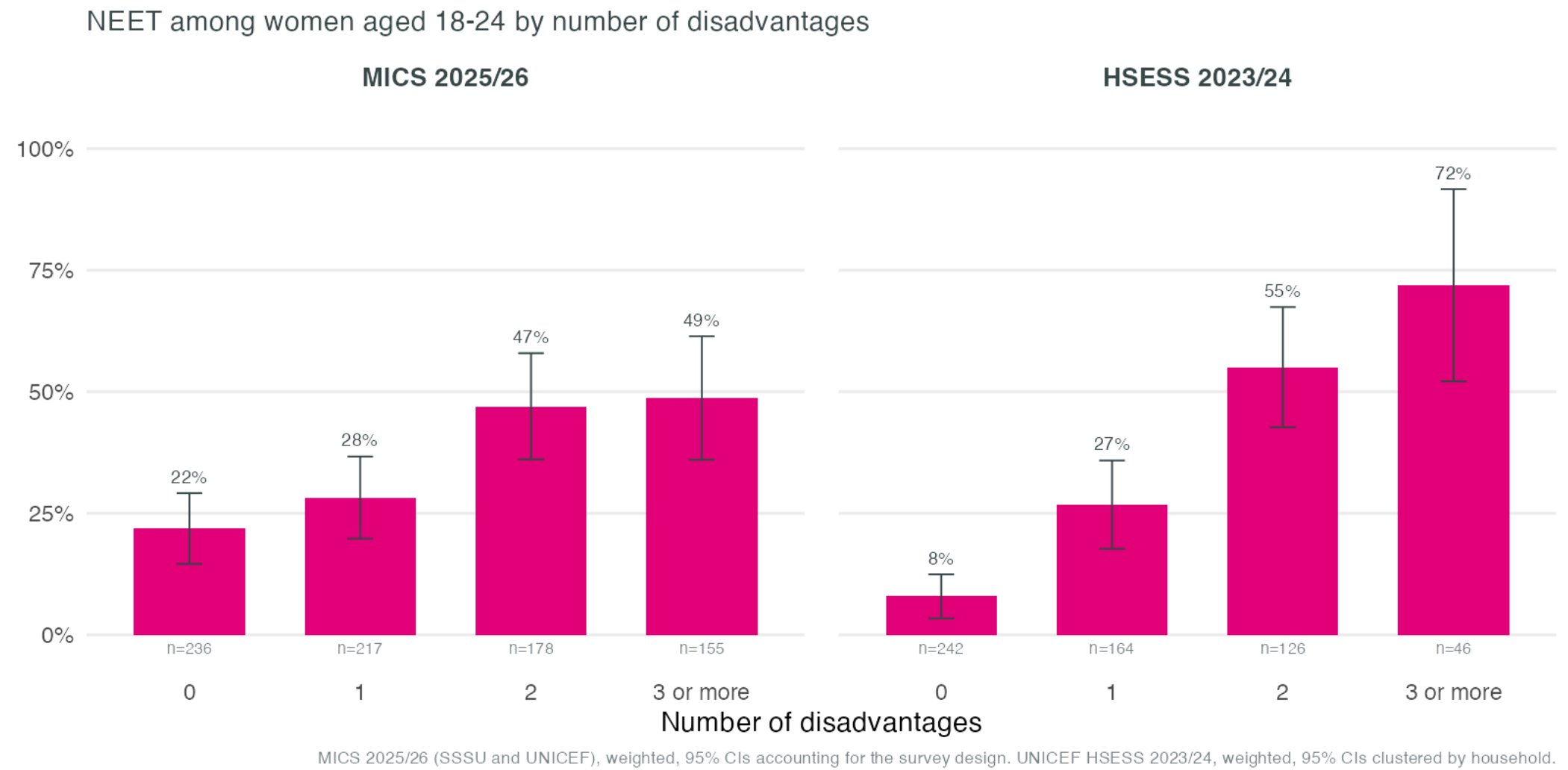
MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. Mothers 72% vs 22%; poorest fifth 48% vs 29%; single-headed households 36% vs 30%; internally displaced 24% vs 31%. Bars show 95% confidence intervals and the sample size; small groups should not be ranked.

Among poor young mothers, NEET reaches 74% to 83%



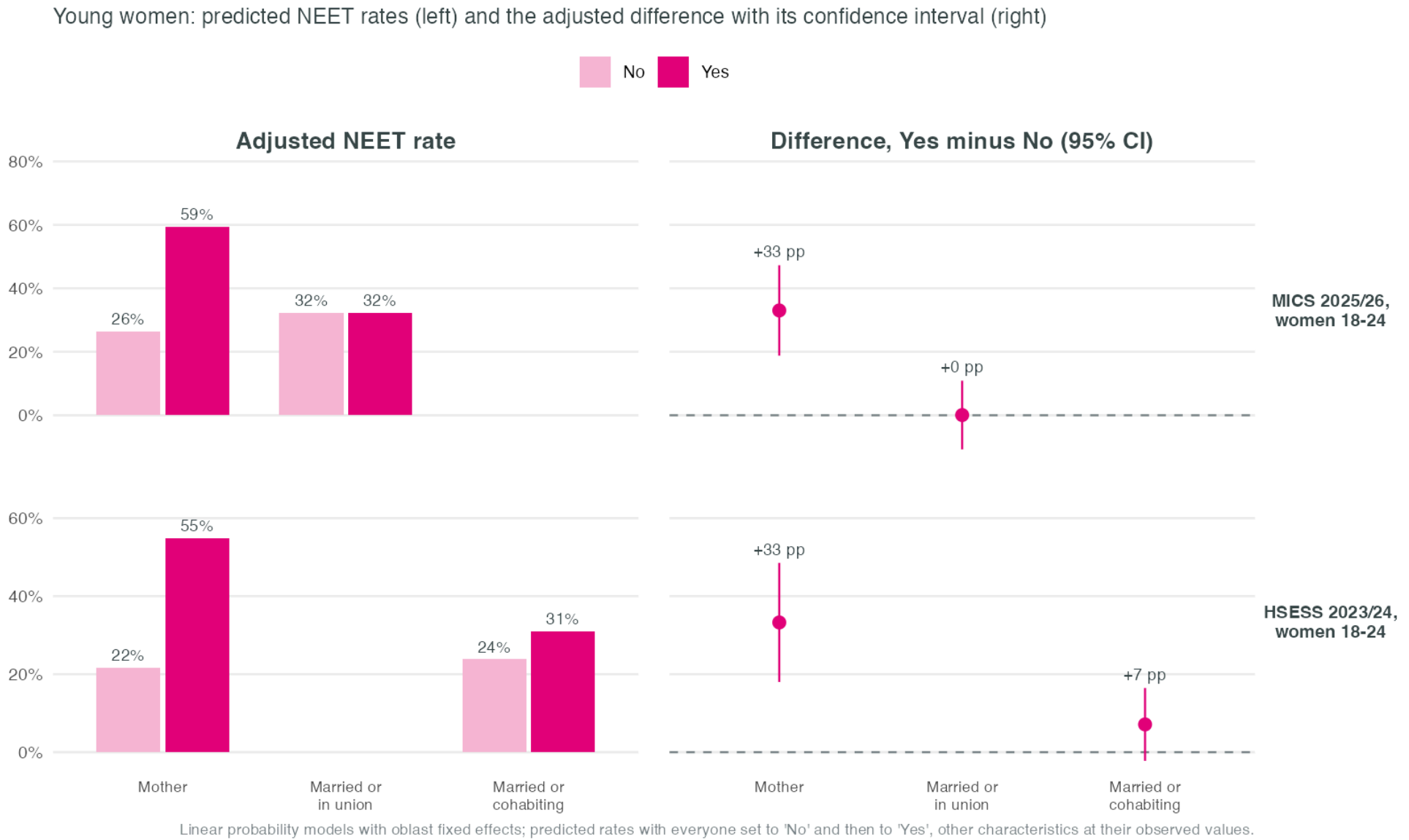
Women aged 18–24. Women with neither characteristic: 21% (MICS) and 13% (HSESS). Poor mothers are 16% of NEET young women in MICS and 30% in HSESS. Poorest 40% by wealth (MICS) or income per household member (HSESS).

Disadvantages add up



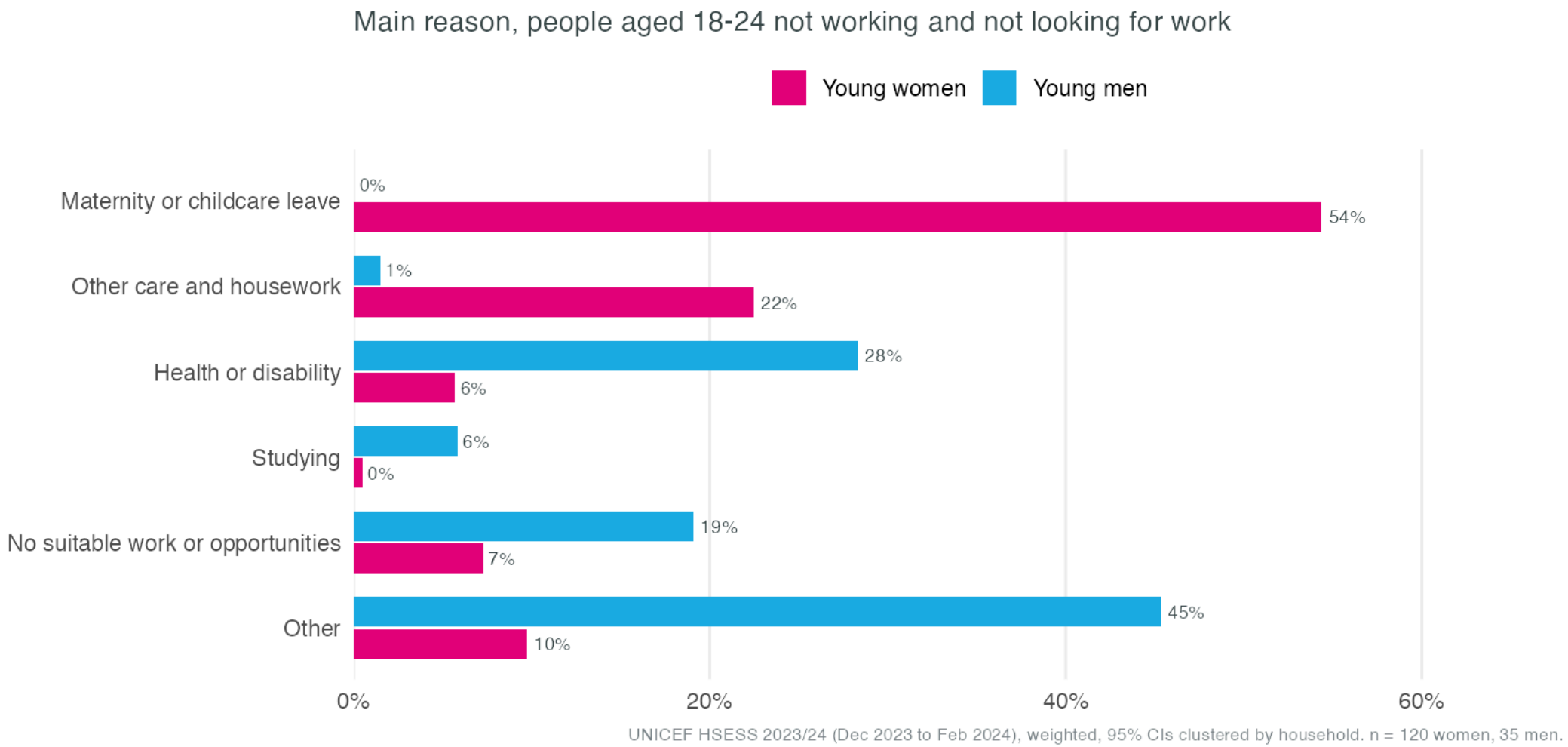
Women aged 18–24. With none of the five disadvantages, NEET is 22% (MICS) and 8% (HSESS); with three or more, 49% and 72%. Disadvantages: motherhood, poorest 40%, rural, displaced, single-headed household.

Motherhood remains the main factor after adjustment



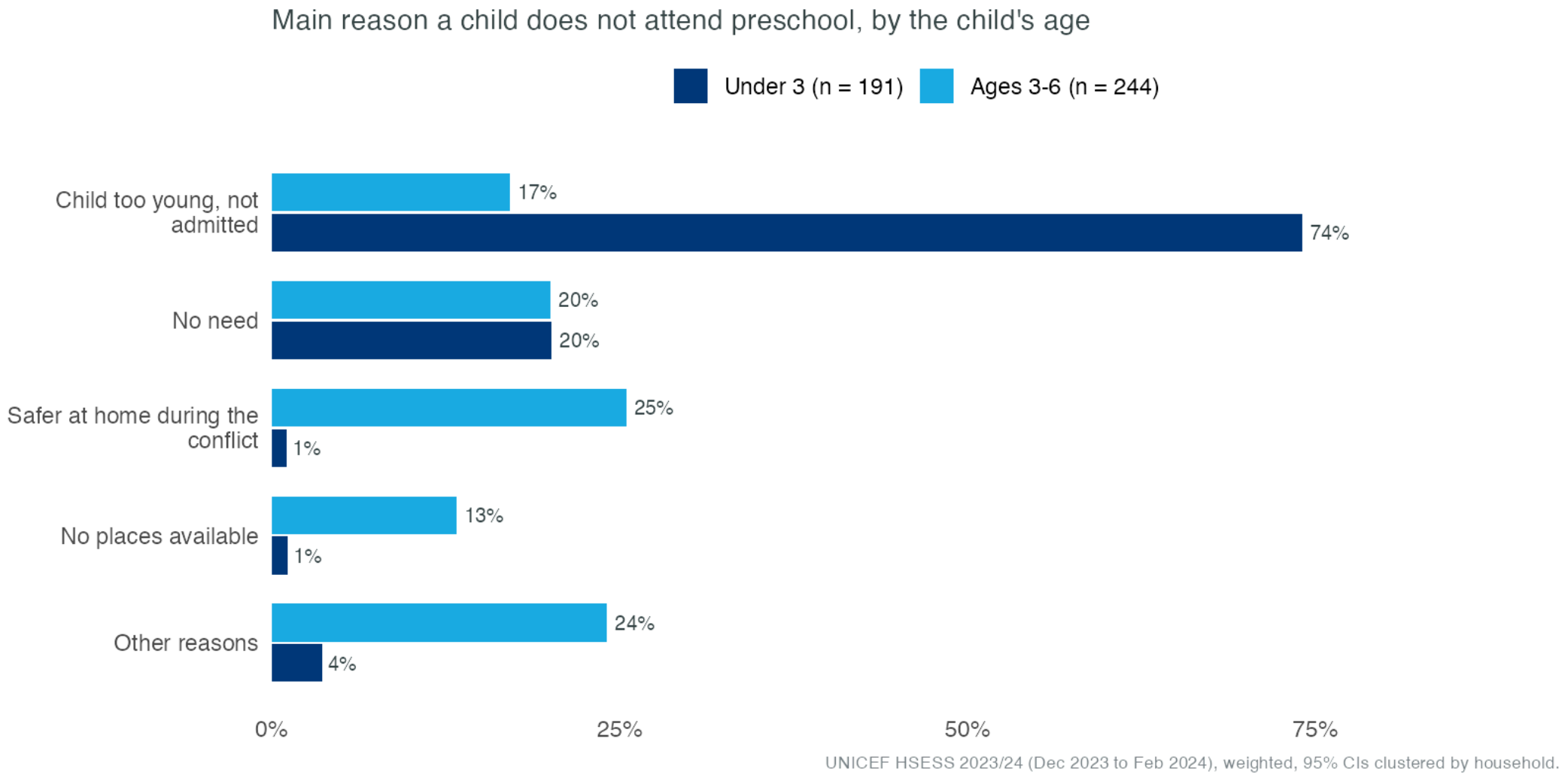
Women aged 18–24, both surveys. Left: predicted NEET rates for mothers and others, and for married women and others, holding age, area, education, income and displacement constant. Right: the difference with its 95% confidence interval. Associations, not causal effects.

Why young women are not working or looking for work



HSESS 2023/24, people aged 18–24 who were not employed and not looking for work. Maternity or childcare leave is shown separately from other care and housework.

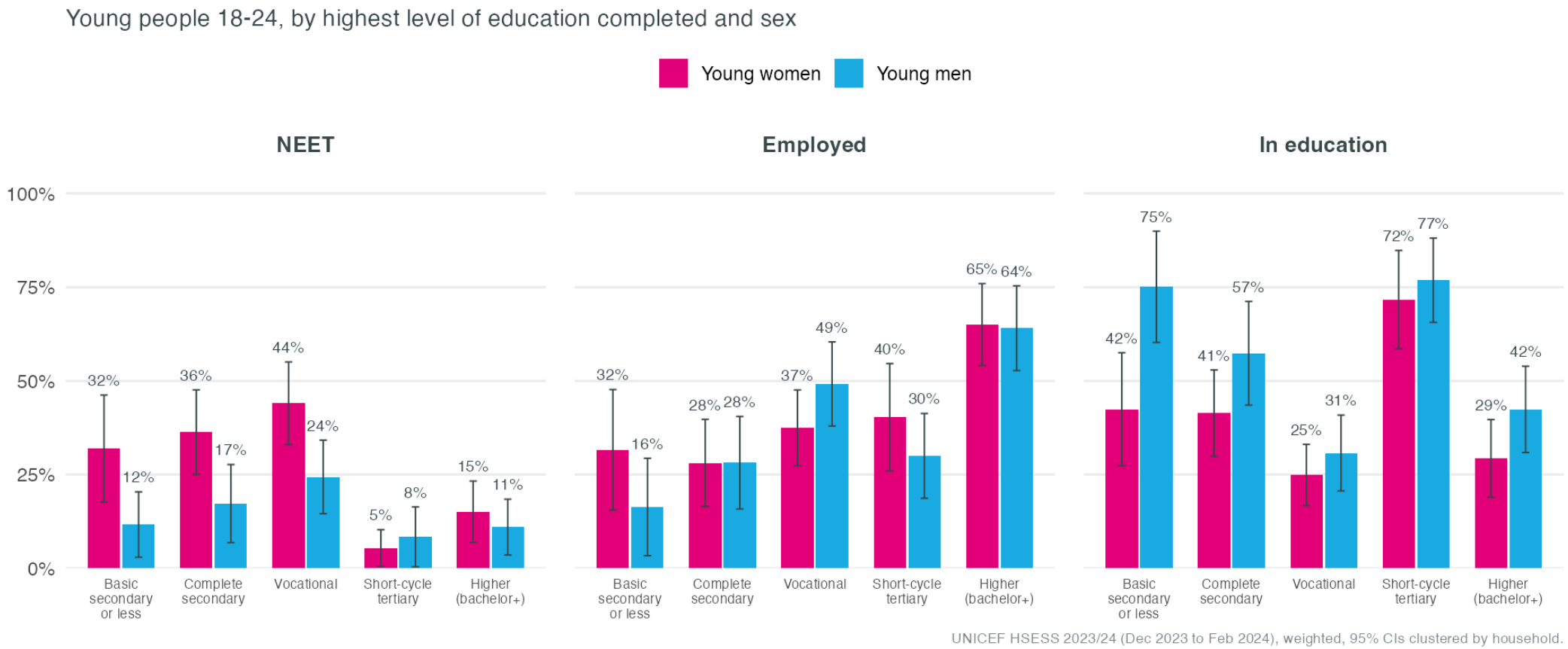
Childcare barriers differ by the child’s age



HSESS 2023/24: main reason a child does not attend preschool, for children under 3 and aged 3–6. Preschool attendance at ages 3–5 is 60% (MICS 2025/26).

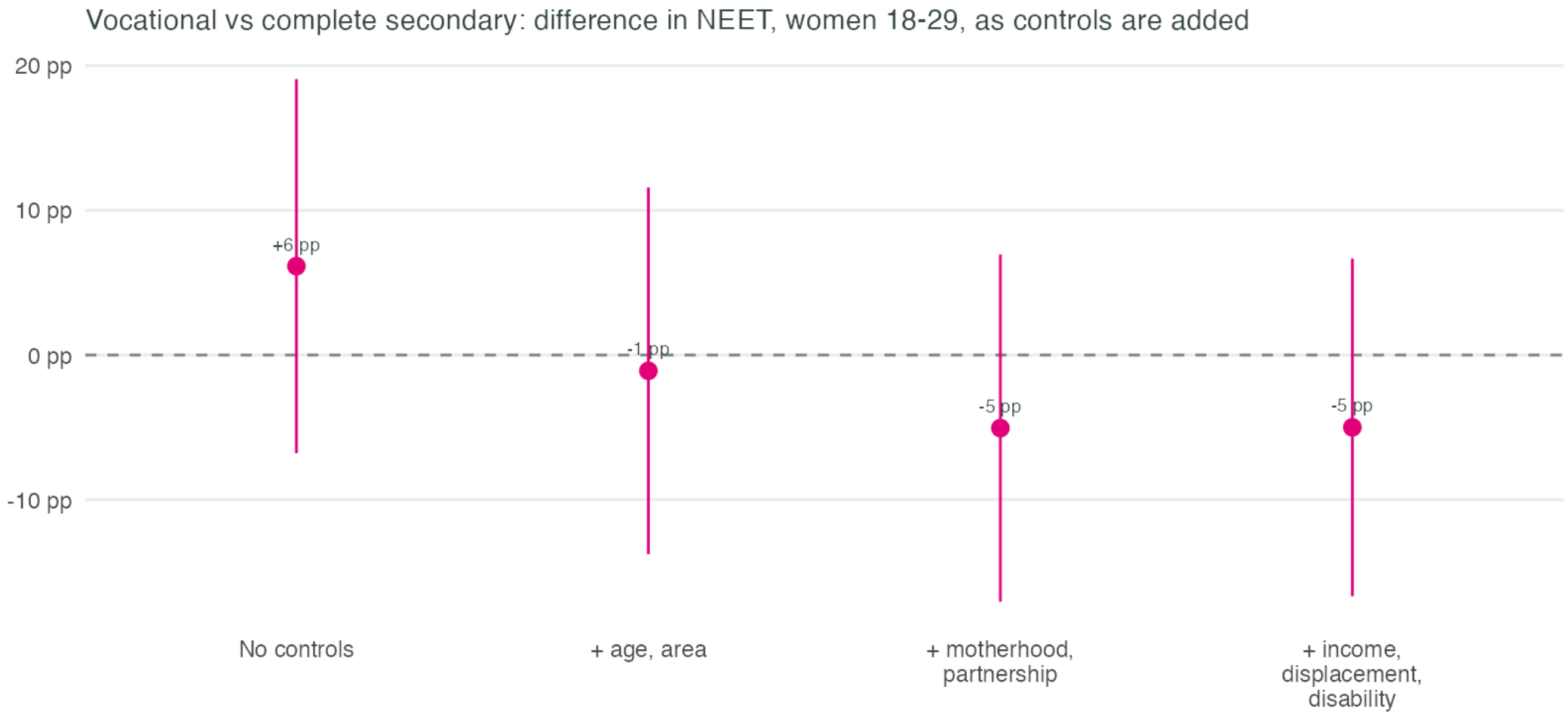
3 · From education to earnings

NEET falls with education



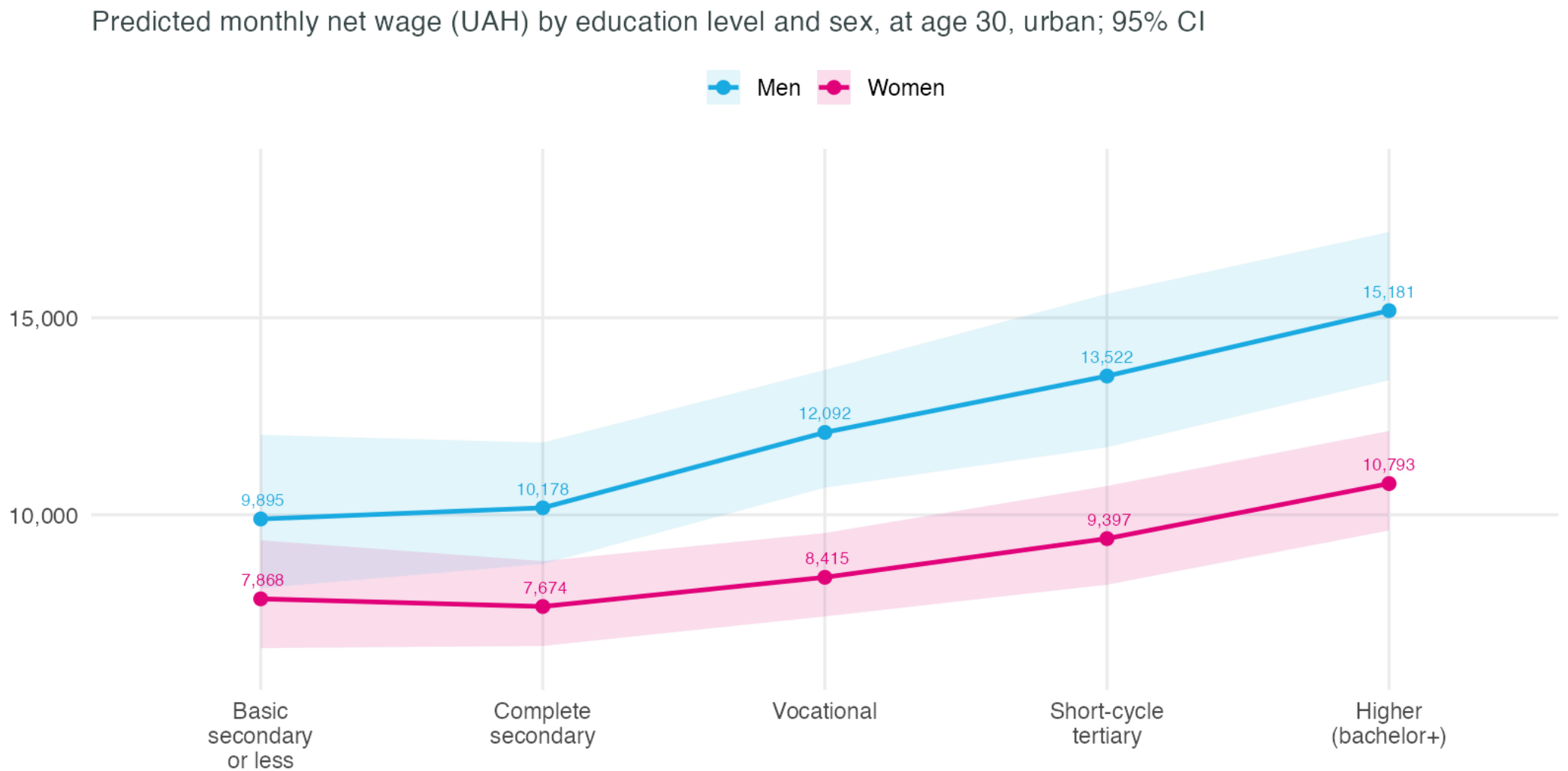
HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24, by highest level completed. NEET among women: 15% with higher education, 36% with complete secondary. Many 18–24 year olds are still studying, so rates by level should be read together with the share in education.

No significant NEET gap between vocational and secondary education



HSESS 2023/24, women aged 18–29. Each dot is a regression coefficient: the difference in the NEET rate between women with vocational and with complete secondary education (linear probability model, oblast fixed effects), with its 95% confidence interval, as controls are added. The difference is 6 pp without controls and -5 pp with all controls; no interval excludes zero, so the difference is not statistically significant in any specification. NEET by level: vocational 48%, complete secondary 44%, tertiary 30%.

Women earn less than men at every level of education



HSESS 2023/24, wage earners aged 18–64. Predicted net monthly wage at age 30 in an urban area. Gap at comparable age and area: 25% with complete secondary, 29% with higher education. Each additional year of education is associated with 5.8% higher wages for women and 7.2% for men. Not adjusted for hours, occupation or sector.

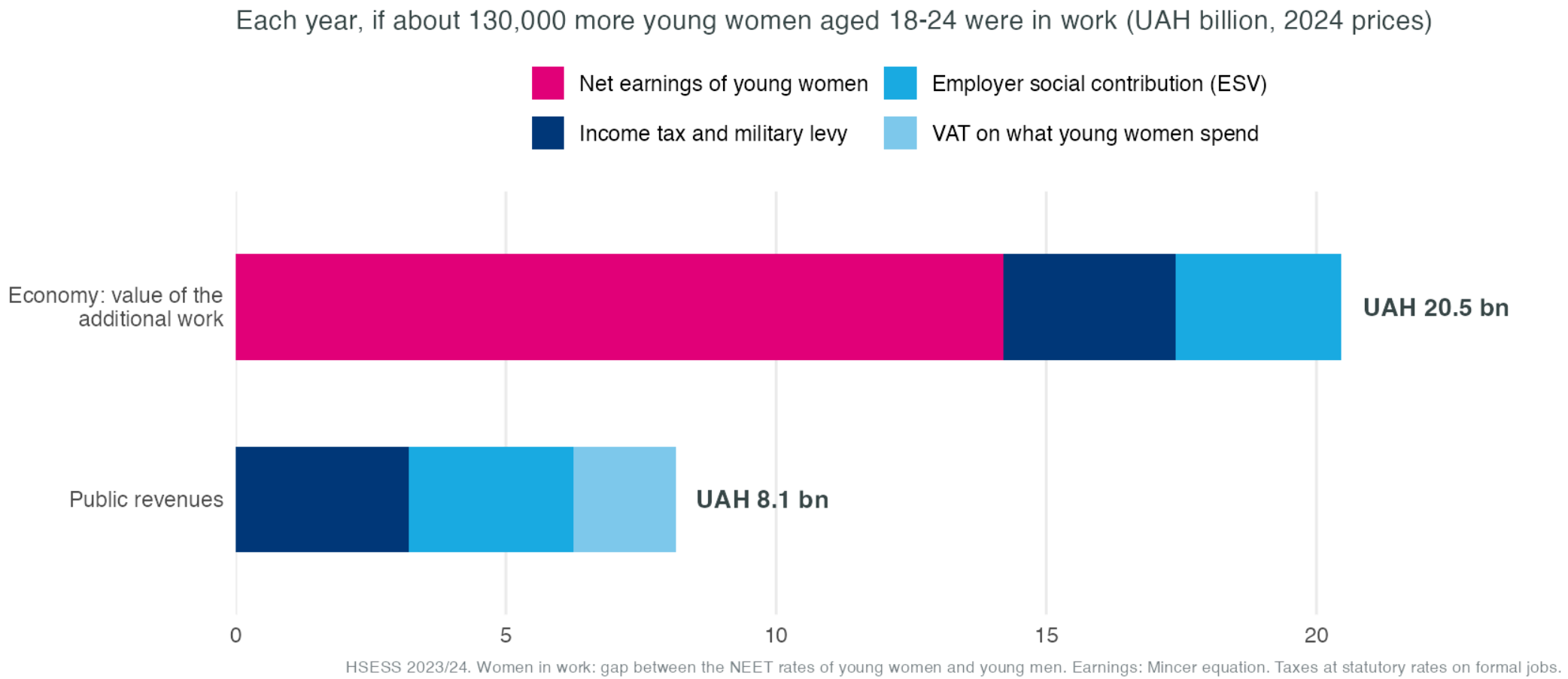
4 · The cost of the gender gap

How the cost of the gender gap is calculated

Step	What is used	Source
1. The gap	27.5% of women aged 18–24 are NEET, against 15.5% of men: a gap of 12.0 percentage points	HSESS 2023/24
2. How many women	The gap applied to the 1,085,000 women aged 18–24 in the areas covered by the survey: about 130,000 more young women would be in work if the gap were closed	HSESS 2023/24 (population-scaled weights)
3. What they would earn	The wage predicted for each NEET young woman from her education, age and place of residence by a Mincer wage equation estimated on employed women: UAH 9,078 a month on average	HSESS 2023/24
4. Formal jobs	75% of the new jobs are formal, as among employed young women today	HSESS 2023/24
5. What the economy and the budget gain	Economy: what employers would pay for this work (gross wage plus employer social contribution). Public revenues: income tax, military levy, employer social contribution (ESV) and VAT	Statutory rates

The cost of inaction is the earning potential lost each year that the gap remains: how much more the economy and public revenues would receive if young women were NEET at the same rate as young men. Wages are from December 2023 to February 2024, so all comparisons use 2024 values. Assumptions, the wage equation and a sensitivity analysis are at the start of the appendix.

Closing the gender gap would add UAH 20.5 billion a year to the economy and UAH 8.1 billion to public revenues



About 130,000 more young women in work, each earning UAH 9,078 a month on average (predicted by the wage equation). Public revenues: income tax and military levy UAH 3.2 billion, employer social contribution UAH 3.1 billion, VAT UAH 1.9 billion. Over a working life to age 60, each of these young women would generate about UAH 2.8 million for the economy and UAH 1.1 million in public revenues (present values at 5%).

What this means for the budget

0.27%

of GDP in 2024

UAH 20.5 billion against GDP of UAH 7,659 billion

0.22%

of public revenues in 2024

UAH 8.1 billion against UAH 3,646 billion in state budget taxes and social contributions

15%

of public spending on preschool education in 2024

UAH 8.1 billion against UAH 52.6 billion budgeted for preschool education

Each year the gender gap remains, the public budget forgoes revenues equal to about 15% of what it spends on preschool education, the service most closely linked to young mothers' ability to work. Sources: GDP, State Statistics Service of Ukraine (2024 estimate); state budget taxes and fees (general and special funds) and ESV, Ministry of Finance (2024 execution); preschool spending, A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024). All values in 2024 prices, the year the wages were collected.

How to read this estimate

Is there demand for these workers?

- Employers report record shortages: 69% of industrial firms cited a lack of workers in May 2026 (IER monthly enterprise survey), and 78% of employers reported a shortage in 2026 (OLX Robota and European Business Association).
- Firms are raising wages to recruit and keep staff, and some are hiring women into occupations traditionally held by men.
- But demand is uneven: only 32% of businesses surveyed by the State Employment Service planned to hire in 2026, and unemployment is still high (about 15% in early 2026, Info Sapiens).
- So demand exists, but jobs have to be reachable for young mothers: location, hours, childcare and skills matter as much as the number of vacancies.

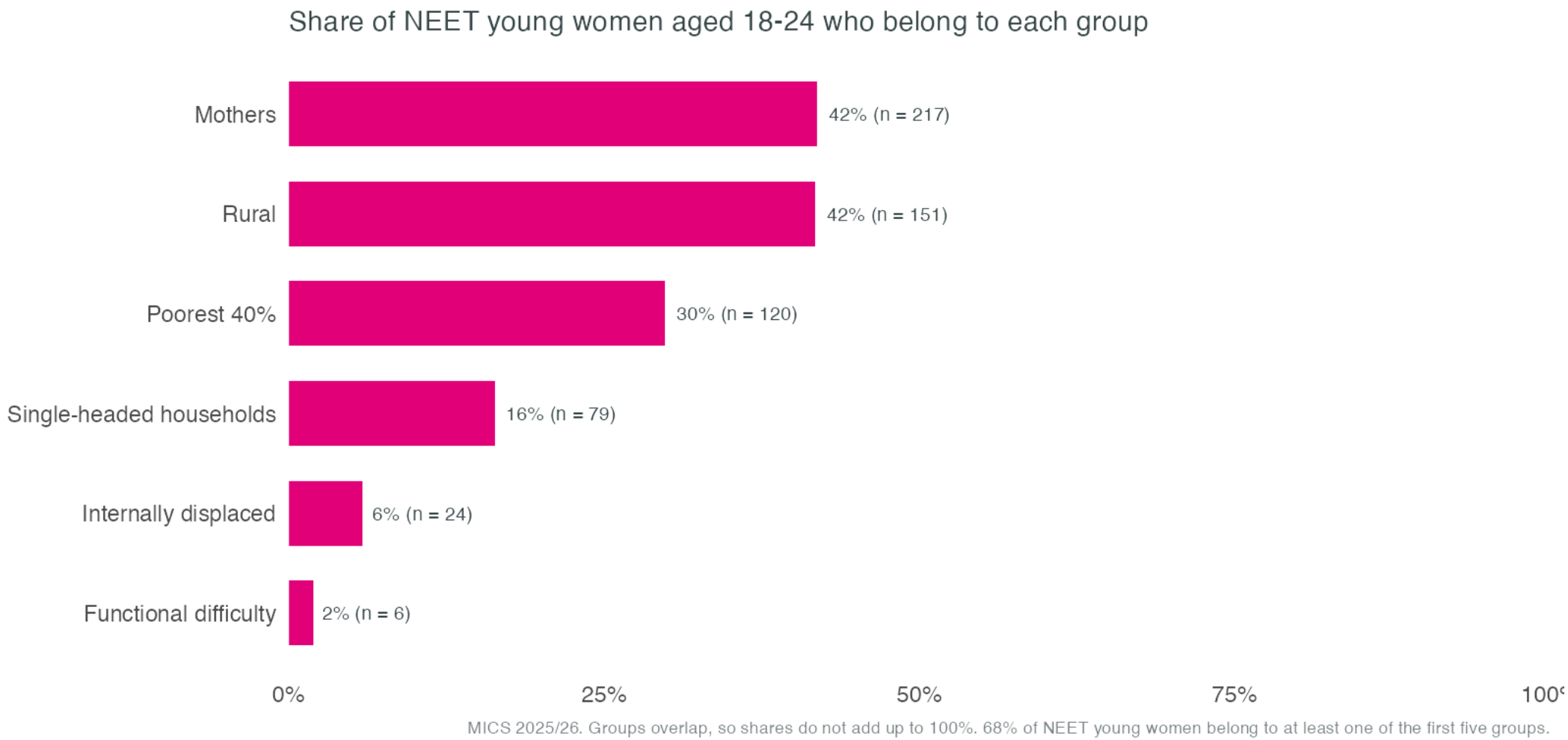
What the estimate does and does not capture

Likely to understate the cost: it counts only earnings and taxes; it leaves out effects on children, on young women's future careers (lost experience), on employers, and the wider economy; it counts only the gap with young men, not all NEET young women.

Likely to overstate it: it assumes jobs are available at the wage of employed women with the same education, age and location, that new workers do not displace others, and that NEET women would earn as much as employed women with the same profile.

How to use it: as the order of magnitude of what is at stake, with a range rather than a single number, and as the benchmark against which the cost of support services can be judged.

Mothers are 42% of NEET young women



MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. Groups overlap, and 68% of NEET young women belong to at least one of the first five. Mothers are the largest identifiable group, so support that works for young mothers addresses the largest part of the gap.

What this means for investment decisions

Each young woman who moves into work generates about **UAH 62,505 a year in public revenues** and UAH 156,915 for the economy.

The table shows the share of participants in a programme who would need to move into work, and stay in work, for the programme to recover its cost.

For example, a programme costing UAH 25,000 per participant recovers its cost from public revenues alone if 40% of participants work for one year, or 14% for three years.

These thresholds use only the estimates in this analysis; whether a given service reaches them is for programme data to show.

Cost per participant (UAH)	Years in work	Public revenues only	Value to the economy
10,000	1	16%	6%
10,000	3	6%	2%
25,000	1	40%	16%
25,000	3	14%	6%
50,000	1	80%	32%
50,000	3	28%	11%
100,000	1	160%	64%
100,000	3	56%	22%

Additional employment attributable to the programme, at the central wage and formality, discounted at 5%. Costs are the present value of total programme cost per participant.

5 · Conclusions and recommendations

Key messages

1. The problem is large. 31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET (MICS 2025/26); in HSESS, 28% of women against 16% of men.

2. The gap is about education, not employment. Young women and men work at the same rate (34% and 33%); fewer women stay in education (38% against 51%).

3. Motherhood is the main factor. NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22% among other young women, and the difference remains after adjusting for other characteristics.

4. Poverty compounds it. Among poor young mothers NEET reaches 74% to 83%; displacement is not associated with higher NEET.

5. The gender gap is costly. Closing it would bring about 130,000 more young women into work, adding UAH 20.5 billion a year to the economy (0.27% of GDP) and UAH 8.1 billion to public revenues, about 15% of public spending on preschool education.

6. Support pays back through the budget. Each young woman who moves into work returns about UAH 62,505 a year in public revenues.

Priority 1: Learning-to-Earning (First Experience, Earning Engine)

Finding	Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms	Who	What the model indicates
At 18–24, young women and men are employed at the same rate; the NEET gap (28% against 16%) mirrors lower education participation (38% against 51%)	Support young women to stay in education and training, and bridge the exit with first work experience (internships, apprenticeships, first-job support) through the State Employment Service and employers	Ministry of Economy; State Employment Service; employers; education and VET institutions; UNICEF (GenU)	Each young woman who moves into work returns about UAH 62,505 a year in public revenues
NEET is lower with tertiary education (30% against 48% vocational and 44% secondary, women 18–29); the vocational gap against secondary disappears once motherhood and area are accounted for	Do not treat vocational education as the cause: focus on the transition after it, especially for young mothers and rural women, and on guidance towards fields with employer demand	Ministry of Education and Science; VET institutions; State Employment Service; employers	Needs vacancy, pay and entry-requirement data by occupation (SES dashboard, SSSU)
Women earn less than men at every level of education (median wage gap at 18–24: 29%), although informal work is less common among women (25% against 36%)	Pair first-job pathways with formal contracts and decent-work standards; monitor the pay gap by occupation	Employers; State Labour Service; State Employment Service	Formality raises the return: 75% of jobs held by young women are formal today

Priority 2: Inclusive Access and Navigation (protection and employment)

Finding	Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms	Who	What the model indicates
Motherhood is the main factor: NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22%, and mothers are 42% of NEET young women	Build on eYasla (UAH 8,000 a month for parents who return to full-time work): combine it with flexible working arrangements and family-friendly workplace policies, and give young mothers priority in employment services	Ministry of Social Policy, Family and National Unity; local authorities; employers; UNICEF	Mothers are 42% of NEET young women, so closing the gap depends mostly on them; the cost of support should be judged against the UAH 62,505 a year each one returns in revenues
Poverty compounds it: NEET is 48% in the poorest fifth against 29%, and 74% to 83% among poor young mothers; it is also higher in single-headed households (39% against 27% in HSESS)	Link social assistance for low-income and single-headed households with employment services (referrals, case management), so that benefits and job support reach the same young women	Ministry of Social Policy; State Employment Service; hromadas	Existing benefit registries can identify most poor young mothers
Displacement is not associated with higher NEET (24% against 31%); disability groups are too small to estimate	Keep inclusive outreach through existing services for displaced young women and young women with disabilities, without a separate programme stream	Hromadas; IDP councils; UNICEF and partners	Not estimated; track outcomes as programmes report

Appendix

Cost of the gender gap: key assumptions

Element	Assumption	Source
Gap	NEET rate of women aged 18–24 minus NEET rate of men aged 18–24: 27.5% − 15.5% = 12.0 pp	HSESS 2023/24 (the only source with both sexes)
Population	1,085,000 women aged 18–24, the weighted count in the areas covered by HSESS (excluding areas the survey could not reach); can be replaced by an official estimate (COI$pop_w1824)	HSESS 2023/24 weights
Earnings	Wage predicted for each NEET young woman by the Mincer equation (n = 161): UAH 9,078 a month on average; no wage growth	HSESS 2023/24, nominal UAH, Dec 2023 to Feb 2024
Counterfactual	Zero earnings while NEET	Assumption
Formal jobs	75% formal, as among employed women aged 18–24	HSESS 2023/24
Economy	Gross wage plus employer social contribution for formal jobs, net wage for informal jobs: a lower bound on the value of the work	Statutory rates
Public revenues	18% income tax and 5% military levy on the gross wage; 22% employer social contribution; 20% VAT on 80% of net earnings (consumption share assumed)	Statutory rates
Labour demand	Jobs available at the wage of employed women with the same profile; no displacement of other workers	Assumption; employer surveys report shortages
Budget comparators	GDP 2024: UAH 7,659 bn. State budget taxes and fees 2024: over UAH 3,100 bn; ESV 2024: UAH 546 bn. Preschool spending budgeted for 2024: UAH 52.6 bn	State Statistics Service; Ministry of Finance; A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024)
Not included	Effects on children, employers and the wider economy; lost experience; women's work-related expenses	

Sensitivity: changing one assumption at a time

Assumption	Value	Women in work	Economy (UAH bn a year)	Public revenues (UAH bn a year)
Central estimate	Gender gap; Mincer wage; formality of employed young women	130,300	20.5	8.1
Wage	25th percentile of employed women 18-24 (UAH 7,000)	130,300	15.8	6.3
Wage	Median of employed women 18-24 (UAH 10,000)	130,300	22.5	9.0
Formality	62%, women without tertiary education	130,300	19.4	7.1
Formality	86%, women with tertiary education	130,300	21.3	9.0
Women in work	Only NEET young women already looking for work (11% of them)	34,000	5.3	2.1
Women in work	Gap measured with the MICS NEET rate for women (30.8%)	165,400	26.0	10.3

Each row changes one assumption and keeps the others at their central values. The central estimate uses the gap measured in HSESS, the only survey that covers both young women and young men.

Wage equation behind the cost of inaction

STEP 1 · ESTIMATION ON EMPLOYED WOMEN

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \Sigma_k \beta_k \, \mathrm{Educ}_{ik} + \gamma_1 \, \mathrm{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \, \mathrm{Age}_i^2 + \delta \, \mathrm{Rural}_i + \mu_{\mathrm{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

w_i: monthly net wage of employed woman i · Educ_{ik}: highest level completed (reference: basic secondary or less) · μ: oblast effects

STEP 2 · PREDICTION FOR EACH NEET YOUNG WOMAN

$$\hat{w}_j = \exp(\, x_j' \, \hat{\beta} \,) \times S, \qquad S = \Sigma_i \, \omega_i \exp(\, \hat{\varepsilon}_i \,) \, / \, \Sigma_i \, \omega_i$$

x_j: her own education level, age, area and oblast · S: smearing factor that converts predicted log wages back to UAH · ω_i: survey weights

Sample
Employed women aged 18–64 with a reported wage, HSESS 2023/24: n = 3,112, R^2 = 0.32. Predictions for 161 NEET women aged 18–24.

Estimation
Weighted least squares with survey weights. Coefficients in the next appendix slide.

Limits
No adjustment for hours, occupation or sector, and no correction for selection into work: NEET women may earn less than employed women with the same profile.

Wage equations behind the education and gender results

RETURNS TO A YEAR OF EDUCATION · ESTIMATED SEPARATELY FOR WOMEN AND MEN

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \rho S_i + \gamma_1 \text{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \text{Age}_i^2 + \mu_{\text{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

S_i: years of education implied by the highest level completed (9, 11, 12, 13, 15 or 17) · Return per year = exp(ρ) − 1: 5.8% for women, 7.2% for men · Wage earners aged 18–64 · Standard errors clustered by household

WAGES BY EDUCATION LEVEL AND SEX · WOMEN AND MEN POOLED

$$\ln w_i = \alpha + \Sigma_k \beta_k \text{Educ}_{ik} + \lambda \text{Woman}_i + \Sigma_k \theta_k (\text{Educ}_{ik} \times \text{Woman}_i) + \gamma_1 \text{Age}_i + \gamma_2 \text{Age}_i^2 + \delta \text{Rural}_i + \mu_{\text{oblast}(i)} + \varepsilon_i$$

Adjusted gap at education level k = 1 − exp(λ + θ_k), shown at age 30 in an urban area · Wage earners aged 18–64 · Neither equation adjusts for hours, occupation or sector, or for selection into work

Wage equation for the cost of inaction: coefficients

Term	Coefficient	SE	p
Constant	8.456	0.110	<0.001
Education: Complete secondary	-0.010	0.044	0.817
Education: Vocational	0.087	0.039	0.027
Education: Short-cycle tertiary	0.181	0.046	<0.001
Education: Higher (bachelor+)	0.323	0.038	<0.001
Age	0.029	0.005	<0.001
Age squared	0.000	0.000	<0.001
Rural	-0.212	0.019	<0.001

Dependent variable: log of monthly net wage, employed women aged 18–64, HSESS 2023/24. Reference education level: basic secondary or less. Oblast effects not shown.

How this builds on earlier investment cases

	A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024)	This analysis
Focus	Early childhood development: children under six	Young women aged 18–24 who are not in education, employment or training
Question	Returns to scaling up childcare, preschool, health, social protection and WASH services to 2050	Who is excluded, why, and what the gender gap costs the economy and public revenues each year
Data	National statistics, mostly from before 2022, and regional assumptions	Microdata collected since 2022: MICS 2025/26 and HSESS 2023/24
Link	Estimates that expanding childcare would allow caregivers, mainly women, to return to work	Measures that link directly: motherhood and childcare are the main reasons young women are out of work

The two are complementary: the earlier case argues for expanding early childhood services; this one identifies the young women who would use them and what their exclusion costs. Both use a 5% social discount rate.

Age groups

Age group	Used for	Why
18–24	Main group: NEET, employment, earnings, cost of inaction	In line with government statistics and UNICEF programming
15–17	NEET and employment among the younger group	MICS asks the NEET questions to women aged 15–24; HSESS asks employment questions from age 15
14–17	School attendance	Available for all household members in both surveys

MICS 2025/26 has no men's questionnaire, so NEET and employment in MICS refer to women; comparisons between women and men use HSESS 2023/24 and, for school attendance, the MICS household roster.

Variables and definitions (1/2)

Concept	Definition	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
In education	Attending school or university in the current school year	ED9 (members 3–24); NE3 (women 15–24)	IND_A9	reason_inactiv = 2 (inactive students)
Employed	Worked at least one hour for pay or profit in the reference week, or temporarily absent; production for own household use only is not counted	NE8–NE11, NE20–NE21 (women 15–24)	IND_B1	labour_force = 1
NEET	Not in education or training and not employed	NEET module (women 15–24)	IND_A9, IND_B1	labour_force, reason_inactiv (upper bound)
Labour-force participation	Employed, or looking for work or starting a business	not available	IND_B1, IND_B21	labour_force 1–2
Informal employment	Verbal agreement, unregistered own-account work, or family farm work for sale	not available	IND_B3_1	informal_empl = 1
Mother	Has given birth (MICS) or lives with own child under 18 (HSESS)	CEB	household roster (IND_A1, ages)	not available

Variables and definitions (2/2)

Concept	Definition	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Care work	Caring for children or the sick in the past week (5–17); daily care of own children	CL11E, CL11F	IND_B28_1	reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy)
Internally displaced	Self-reported IDP status	WB10A	IND_A19	not available
Disability	Washington Group functional difficulty (18–49); any household member with disability	AF module	D1_Mult3/4	not available
Economic status	Wealth quintile; household income per member	windex5	V1 / household size	not available
Years of education	Years implied by the highest level completed (9 basic secondary, 11 complete secondary, 12 vocational, 13 short-cycle, 15 bachelor, 17 master)	welevel	IND_A7	education

Key variables (1/2)

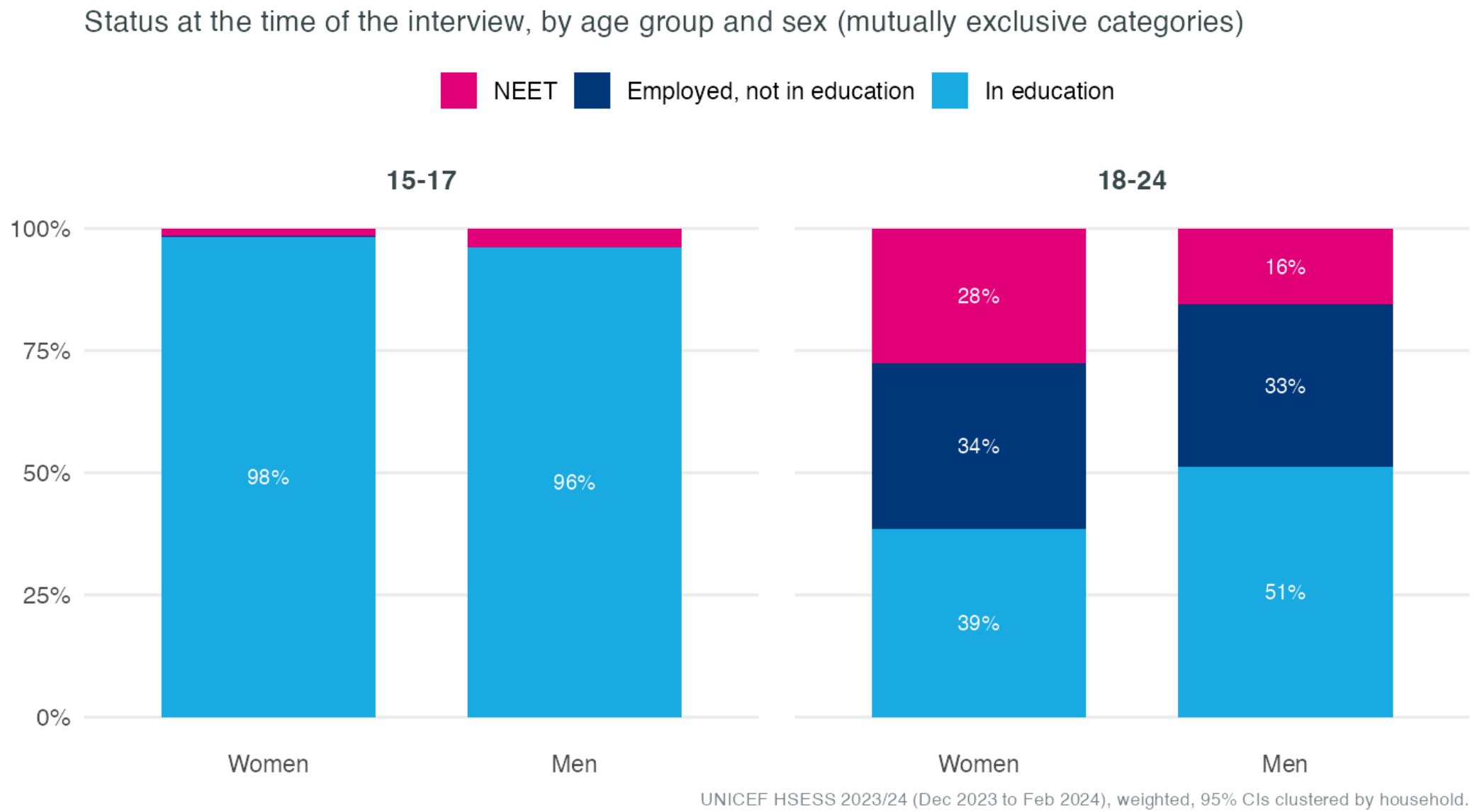
Concept	Use	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Age	Groups 15-17, 18-24; 15-29 for NEET	HL6; WB4 (women)	IND_A2 age in years	age_gr (bands)
Sex	Breakdown by sex	HL4 (household members)	IND_A3	sex
Survey design	Weighted estimates	hhweight, wmweight, fsweight; psu; stratum	Final weight; household key	weight_year; kod_res
Region / area	Regional and urban/rural breakdown	HH7 oblast; macroregion; HH6	OBLAST; SETTL_TYPE	rg; tp_ar
Displacement	Breakdown by displacement	WB10A IDP status; PE3 household moved	IND_A19 IDP status	not available
Disability	Breakdown by disability	disability (functioning, 18-49)	D1_Mult3/4 household member	not available
Marital status	Household formation	MSTATUS	IND_A6	marital_st
Motherhood	Breakdown by motherhood	CEB children ever born; WDOBFC	Own child under 18 (roster)	not available
Care work	Care responsibilities	CL11E/F caring for children or the sick (5-17)	IND_B28_1 daily care of own children	reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy)
Childcare access	Preschool attendance	ED9, ED10A (ages 3-5)	IND_A14 reason not attending	not available
Economic status	Breakdown by income or wealth	windex5 wealth quintile; PE20 income	V1 household income per member	not available

Key variables (2/2)

Concept	Use	MICS 2025/26	HSESS 2023/24	LFS 2021
Changes since 2022	Household context	PE3 moved; PE5 dwelling damaged; PE12 members separated	not available	not applicable
Education level	Education-to-work transition	welevel; ED10A level attended	IND_A7	education; special_dipl
In education	School attendance, NEET	ED9 (members 3-24); NE3 (women 15-24)	IND_A9; IND_A10 type	reason_inactiv = 2
Training	NEET	NE6 courses or training (women 15-24)	not available	not available
Employment	Employment, NEET	NE8-NE11, NE20-NE21 (women 15-24)	IND_B1	labour_force
Job search	Unemployment, participation	not available	IND_B21	labour_force = 2
Reason not working	Reasons for inactivity	not available	IND_B24	reason_inactiv
Occupation / sector	Occupational distribution	not available	IND_B6_2; IND_B5_2	occupation
Job quality	Informality, hours	not available	IND_B3_1; IND_B9_1; IND_B10_1	informal_empl; actual_duration
Earnings	Wage differences, costing	not available	IND_V1_1_1 (wages)	not available

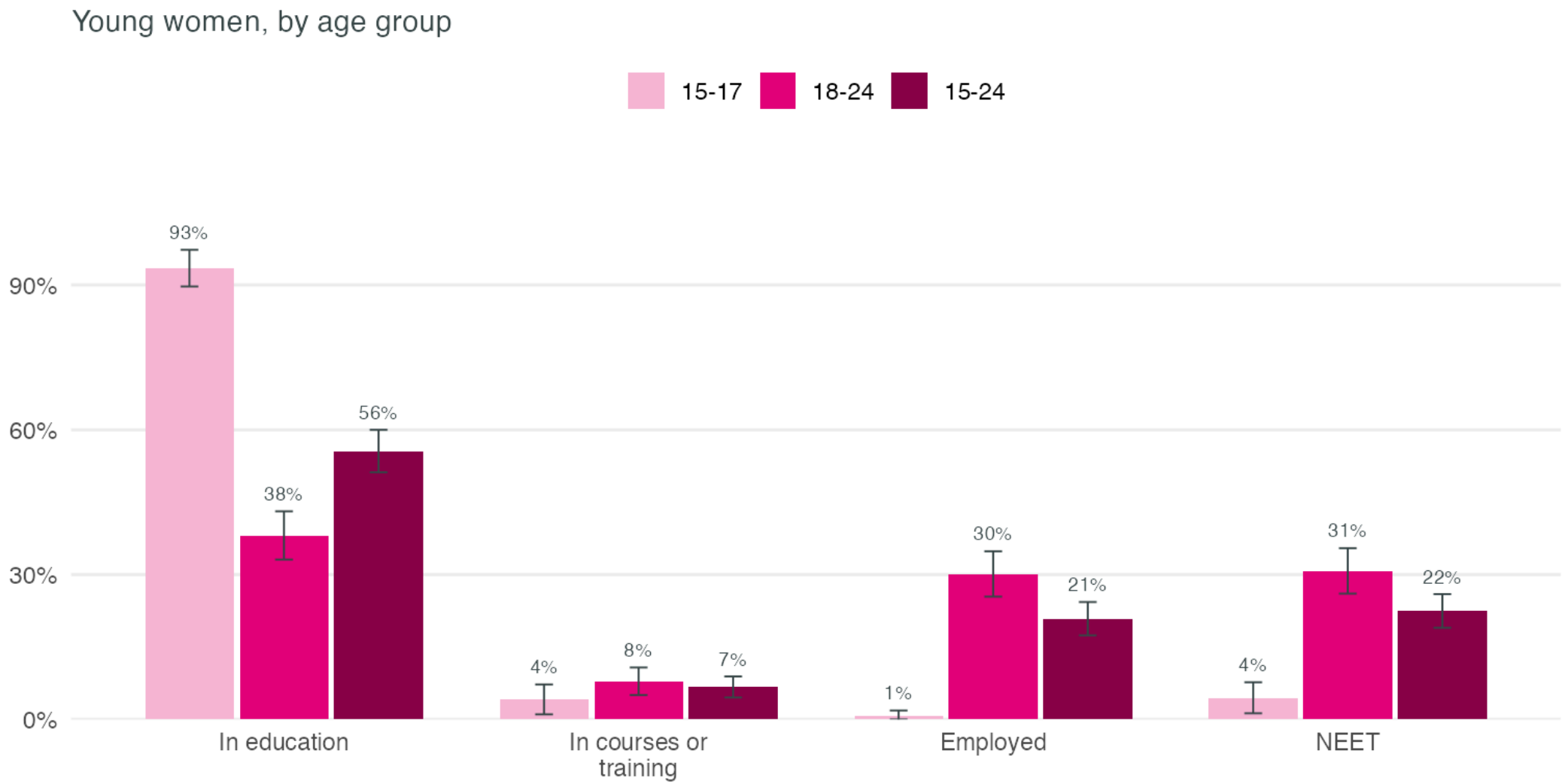
Variable codes as in each questionnaire. Full list of variables in every file: output/inventory/variable_report.xlsx.

Status at 15–17 and 18–24 by sex (HSESS)



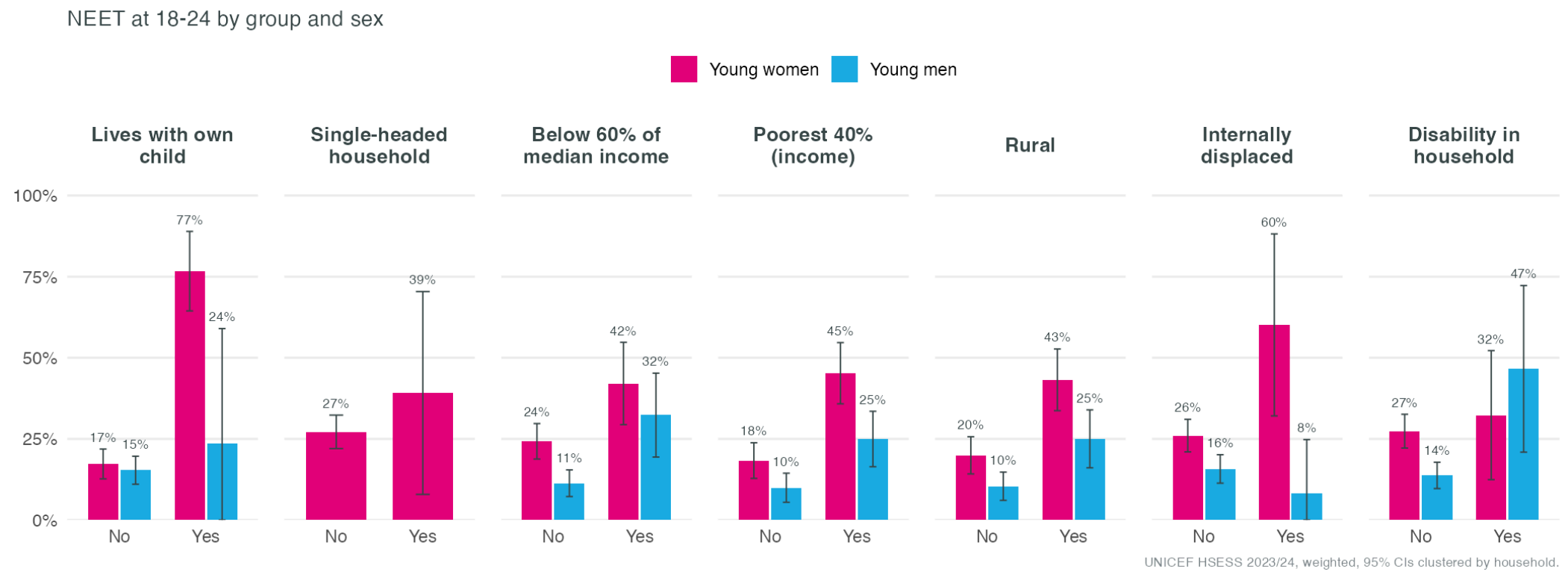
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Young women by age: education, training, employment, NEET (MICS)



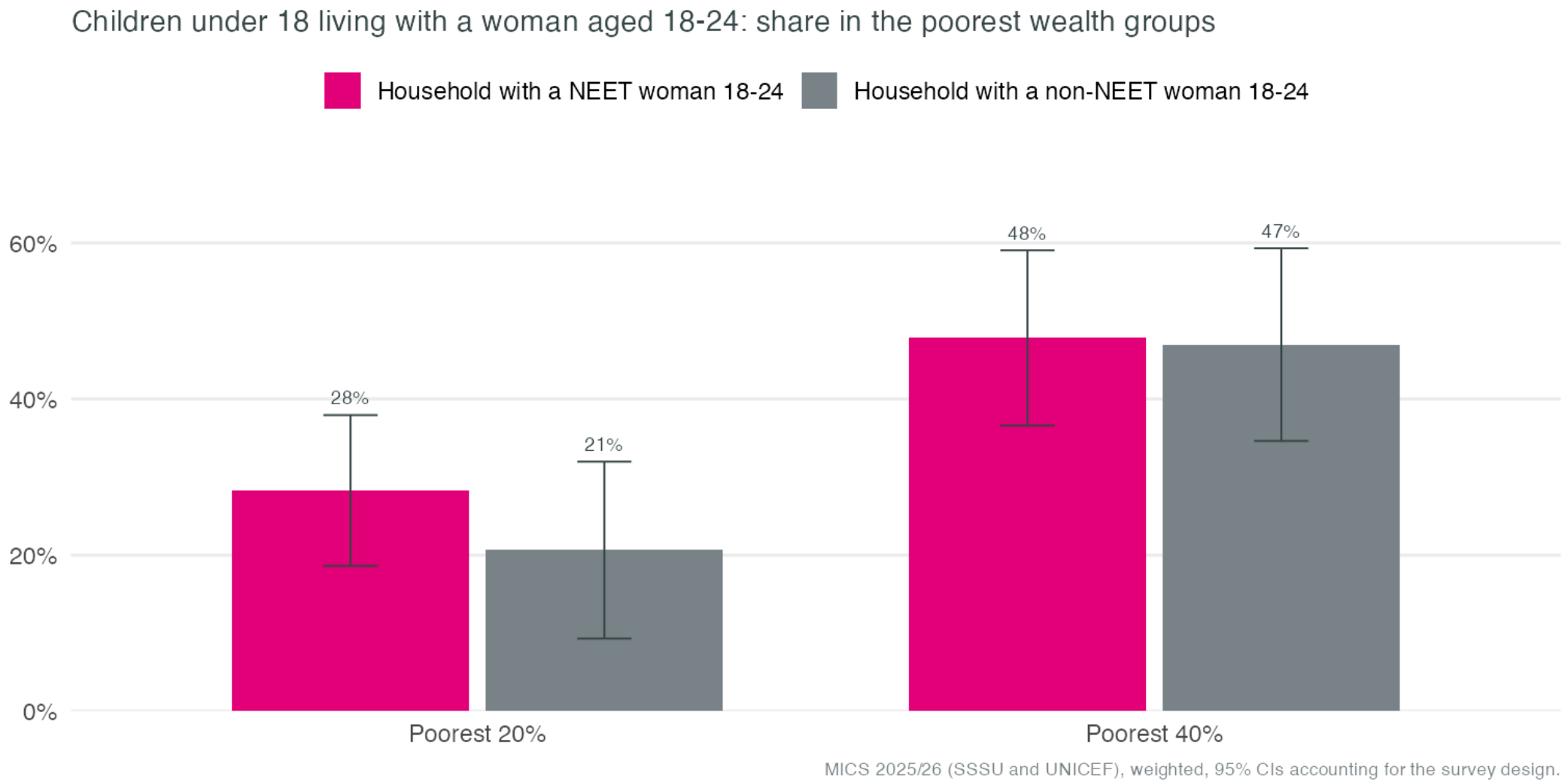
MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

NEET by group, women and men aged 18–24 (HSESS)



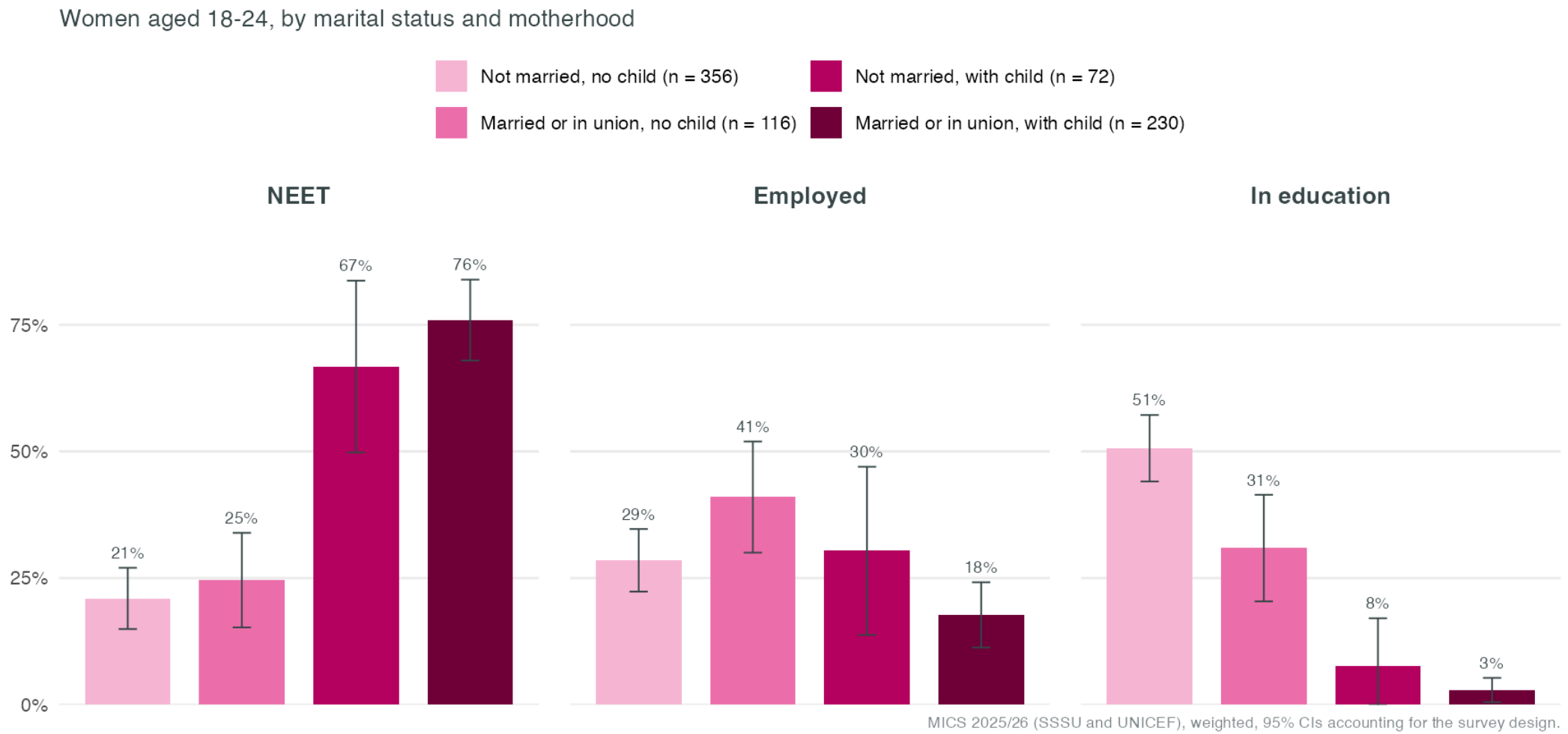
HSESS 2023/24. Below 60% of median income: women 42% against 24%. Single-headed households: 39% against 27%.

Children in poor households, by the young woman’s NEET status (MICS)

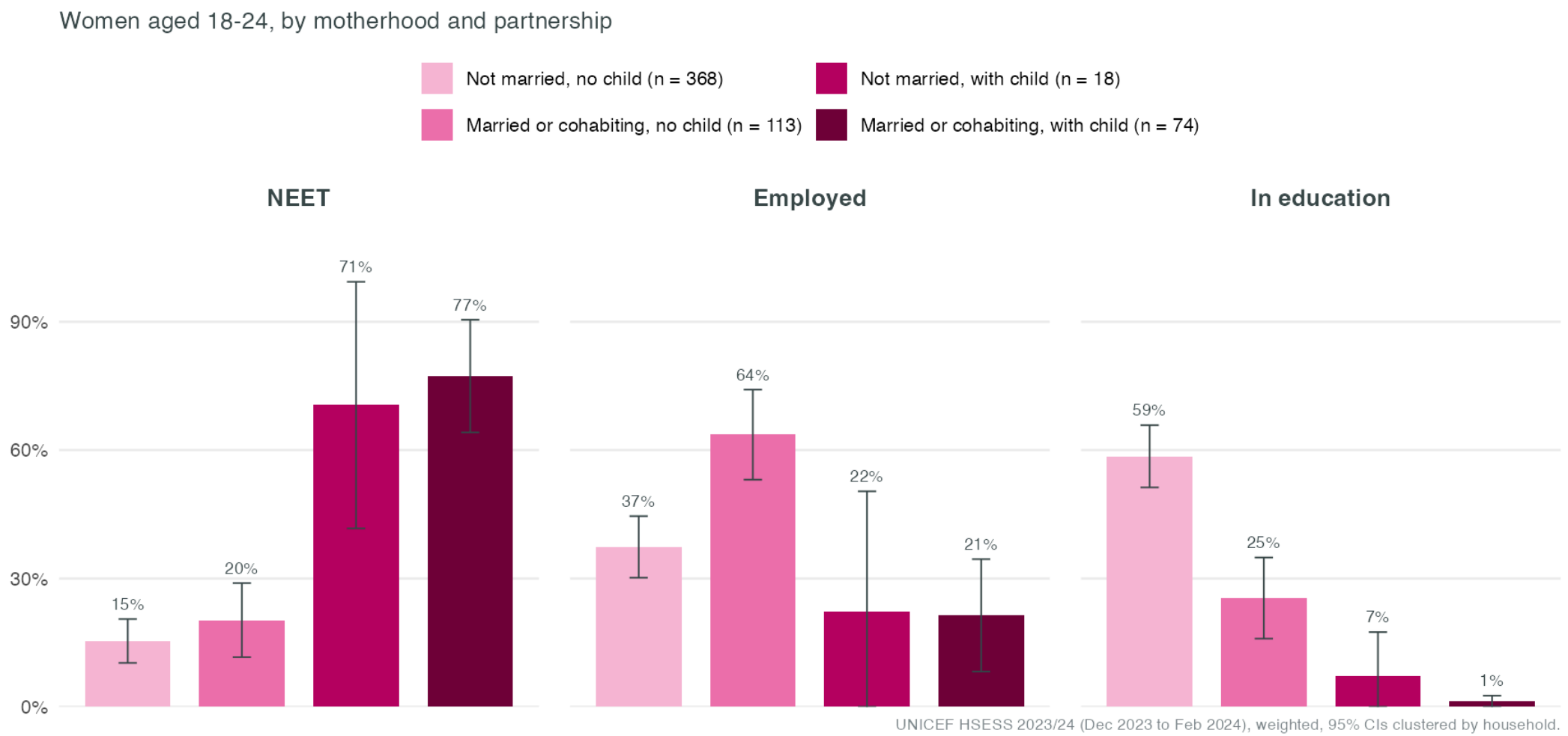


MICS 2025/26, children under 18 living with a woman aged 18–24. In the poorest 40%: 48% where she is NEET and 47% where she is not. The two are similar: children living with young women are more often in poor households regardless of her NEET status.

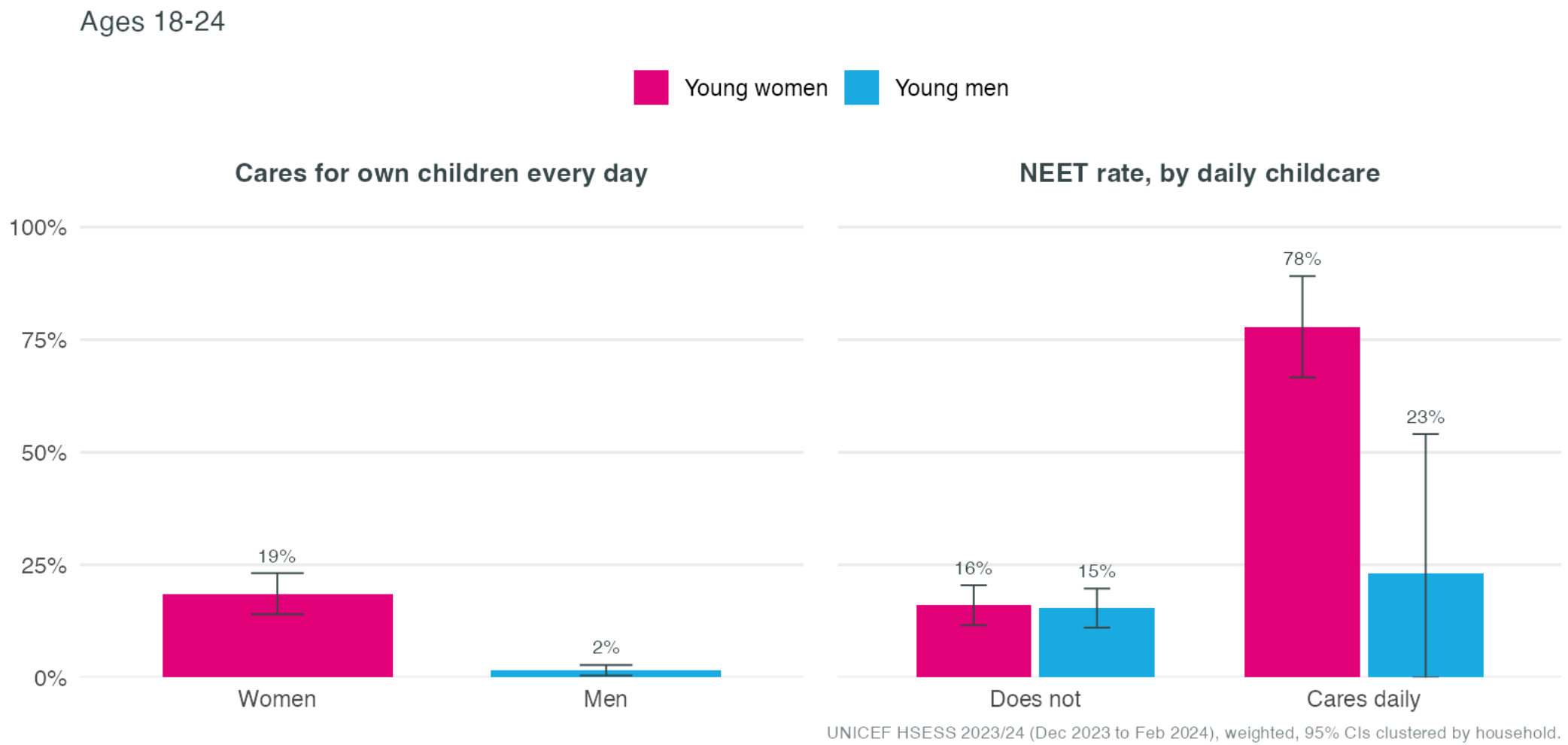
Marital status and motherhood, women 18–24 (MICS)



Motherhood and partnership, women 18–24 (HSESS)

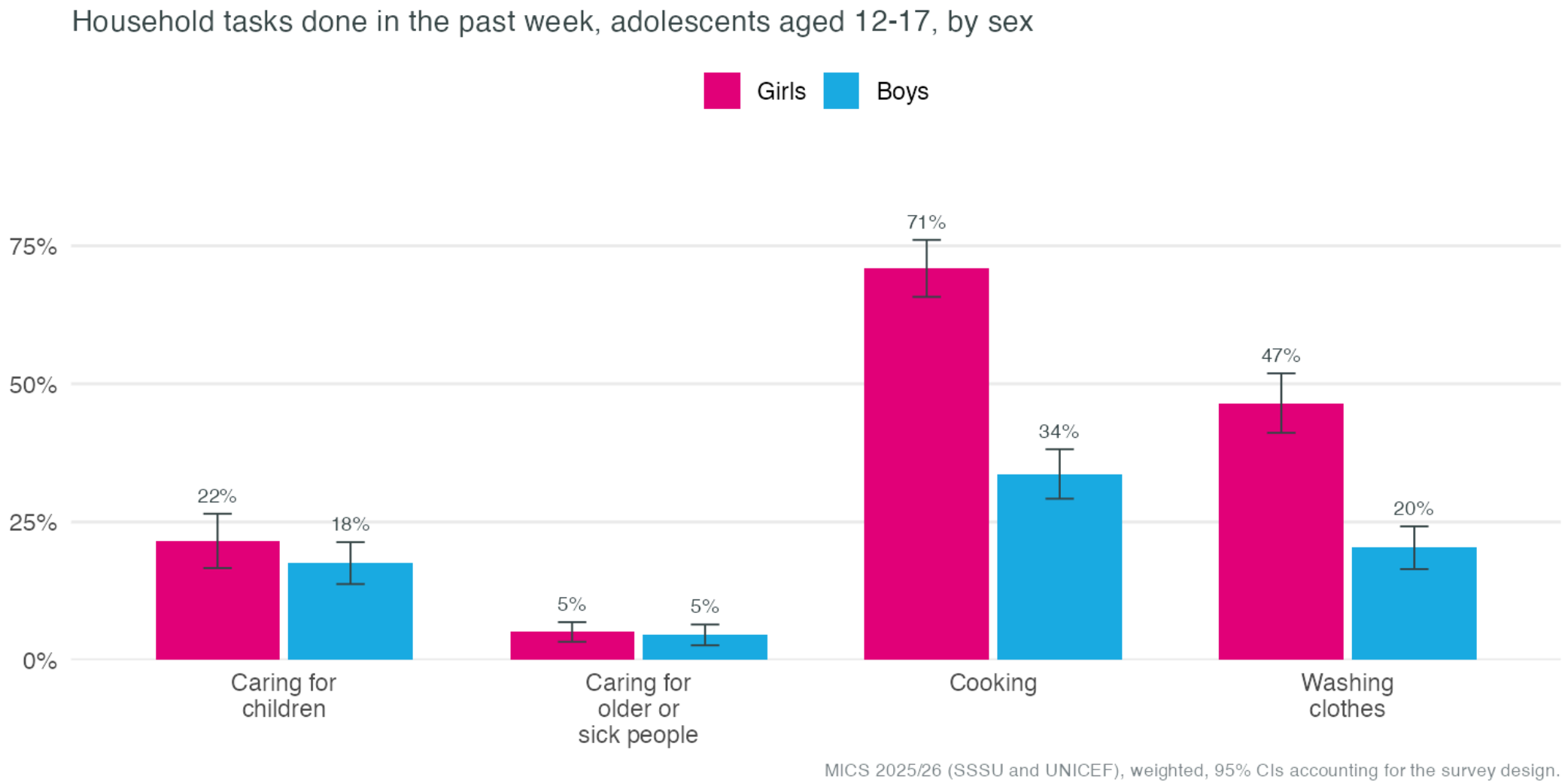


Daily childcare and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



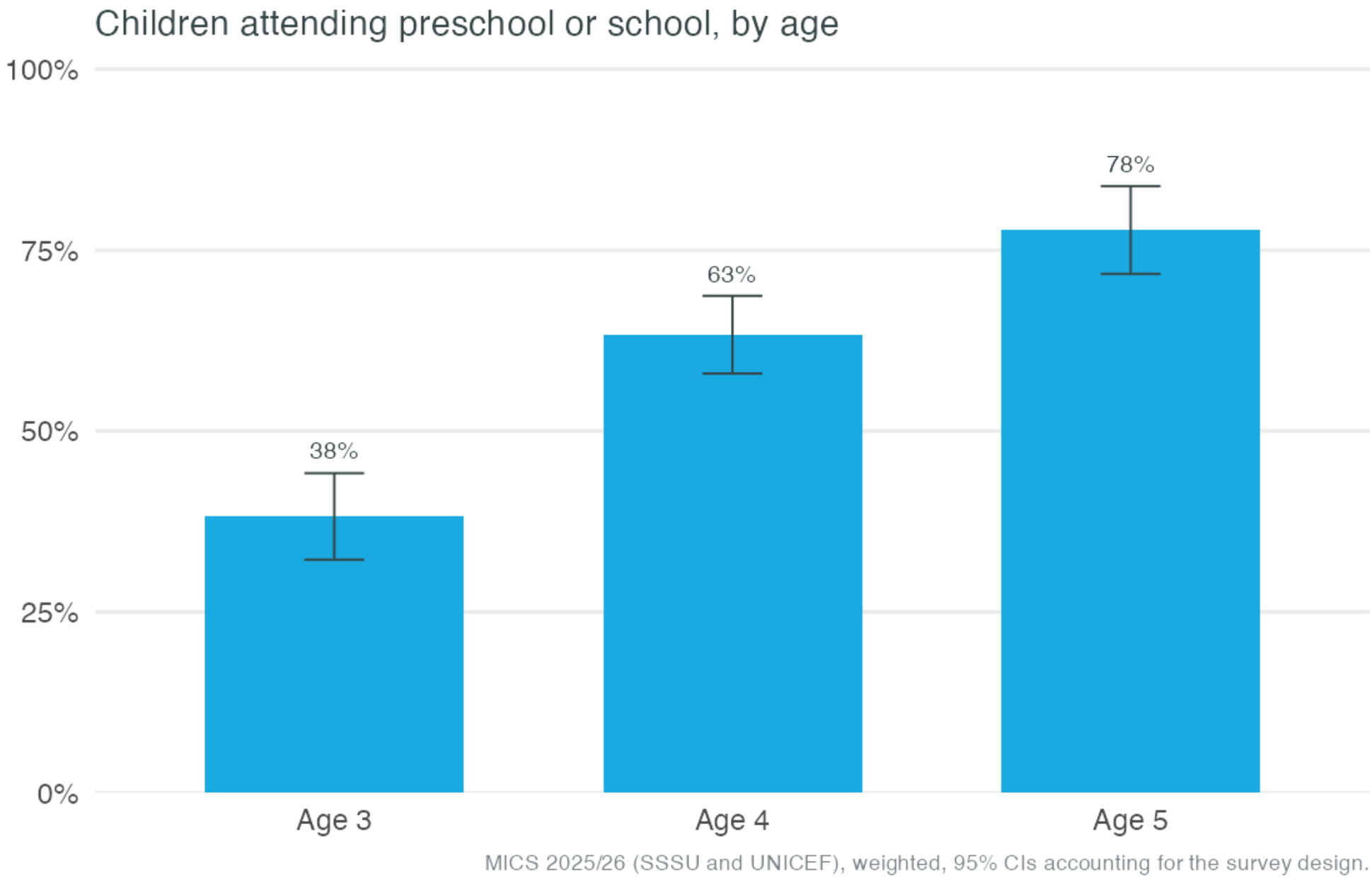
Daily care of own children: women 19%, men 2%. NEET among women who care daily: 78%; among others: 16%.

Care work among adolescents aged 12–17 (MICS)

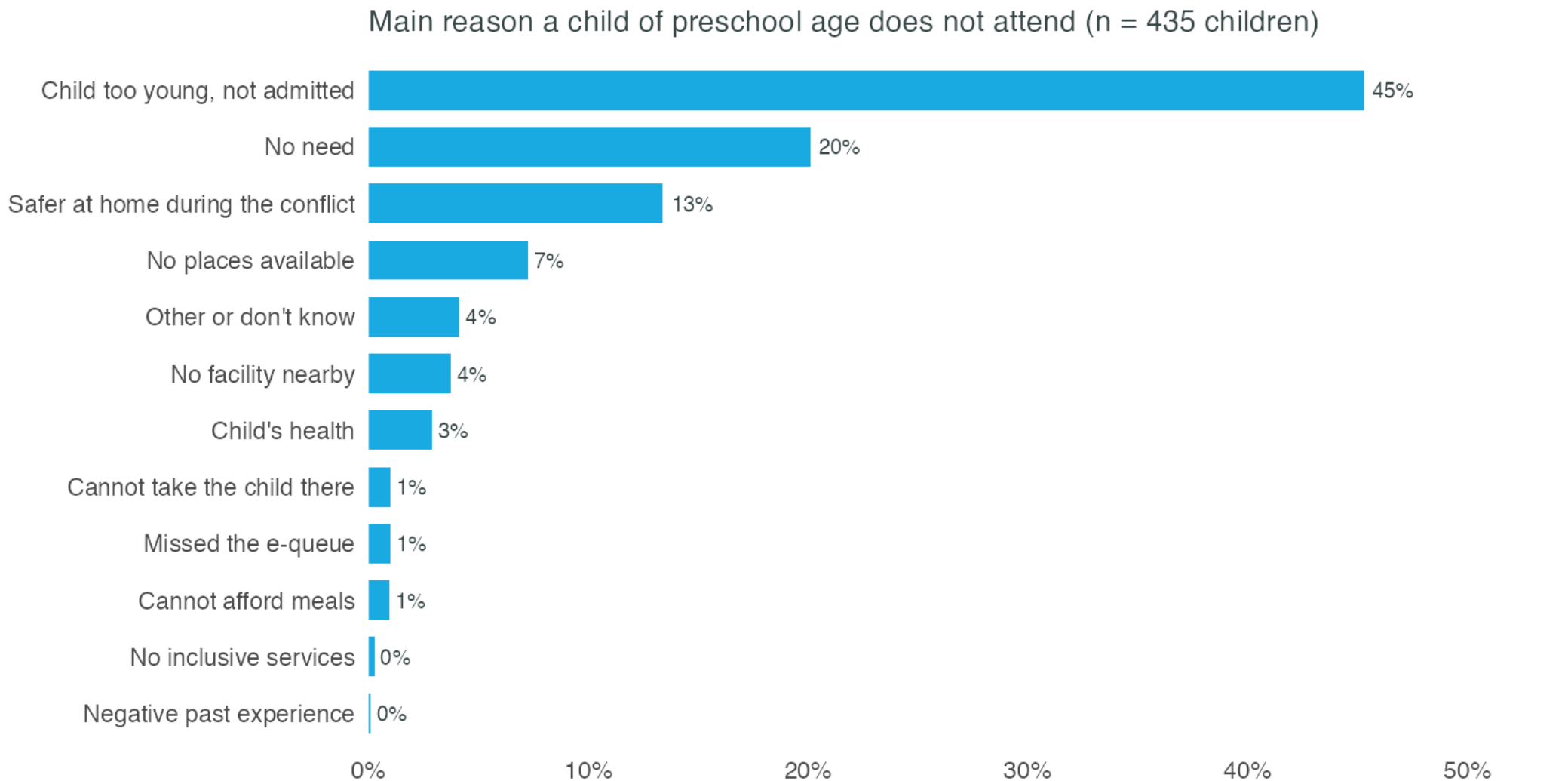


Cared for children in the past week: girls 22%, boys 18%.

Preschool attendance by age (MICS)

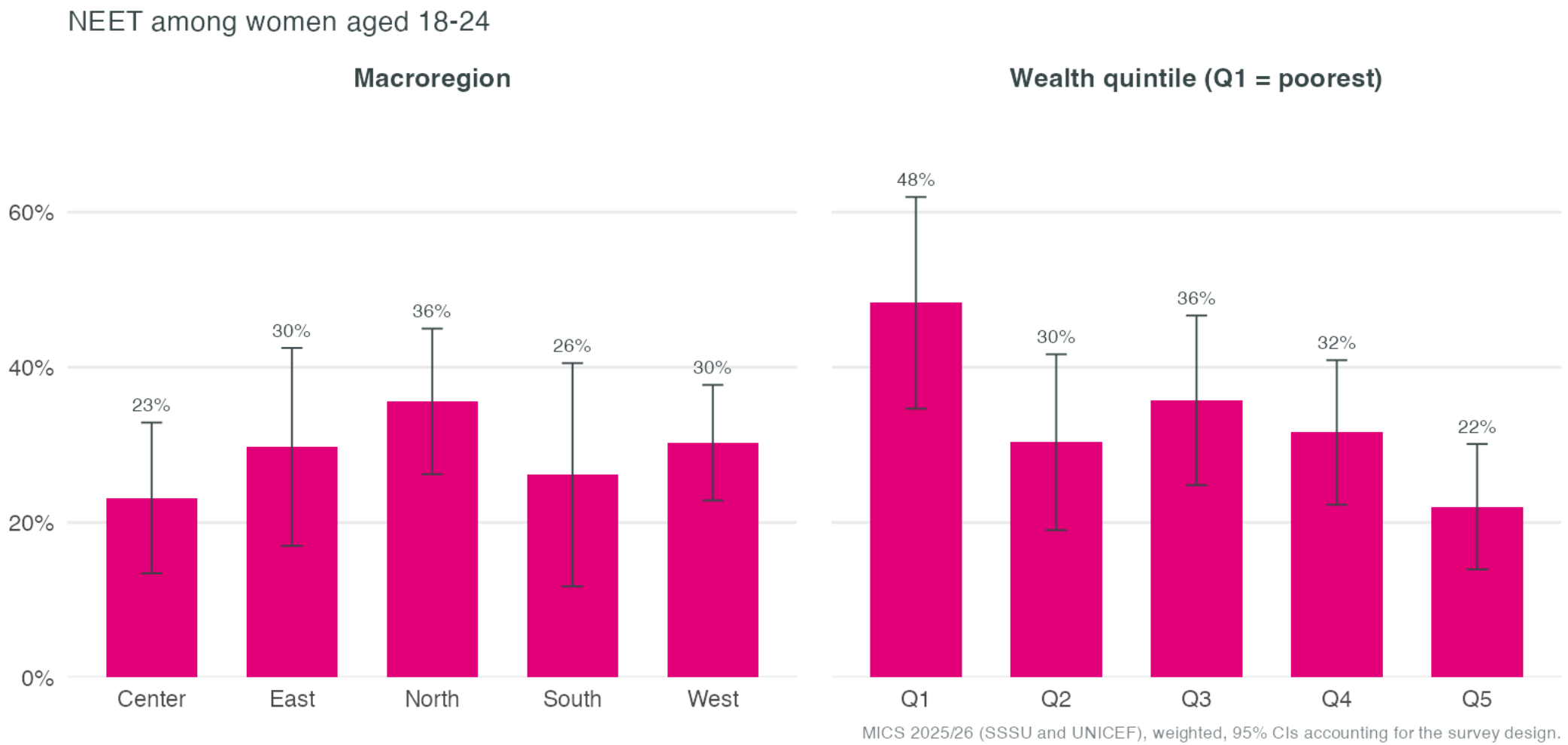


Reasons for not attending preschool, all children (HSESS)



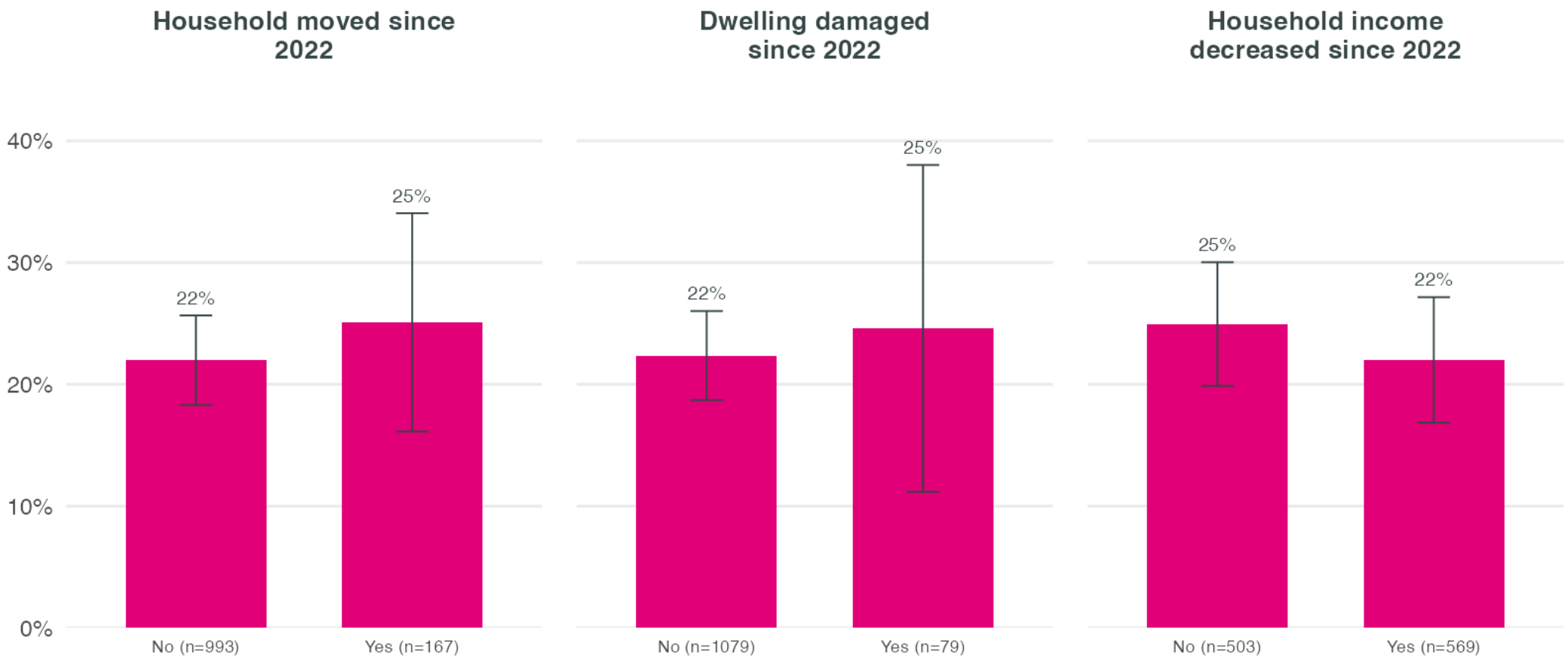
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

NEET by macroregion and wealth, women 18–24 (MICS)



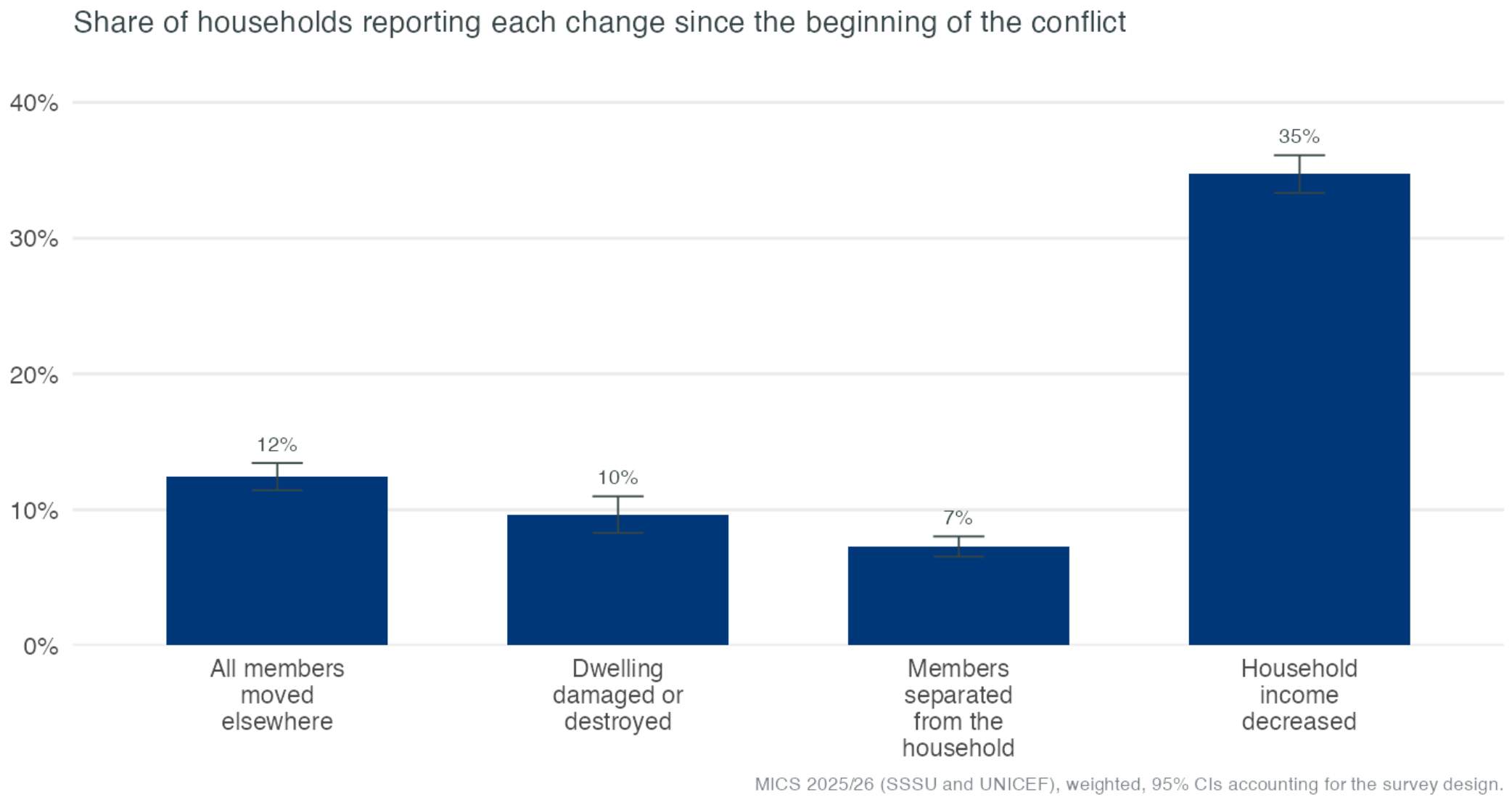
NEET by household changes since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)

NEET among women aged 15-24, by household changes since the beginning of the conflict



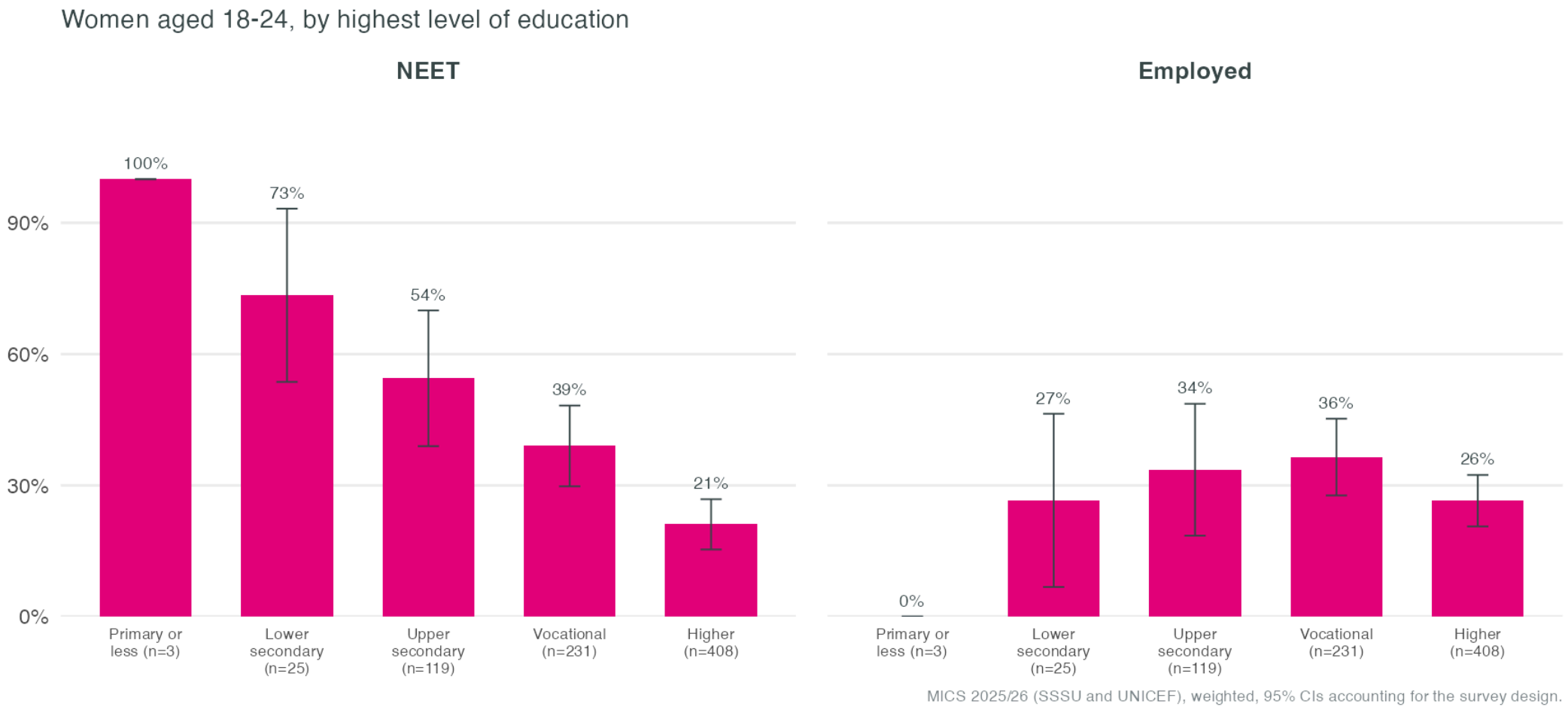
MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

Households since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)



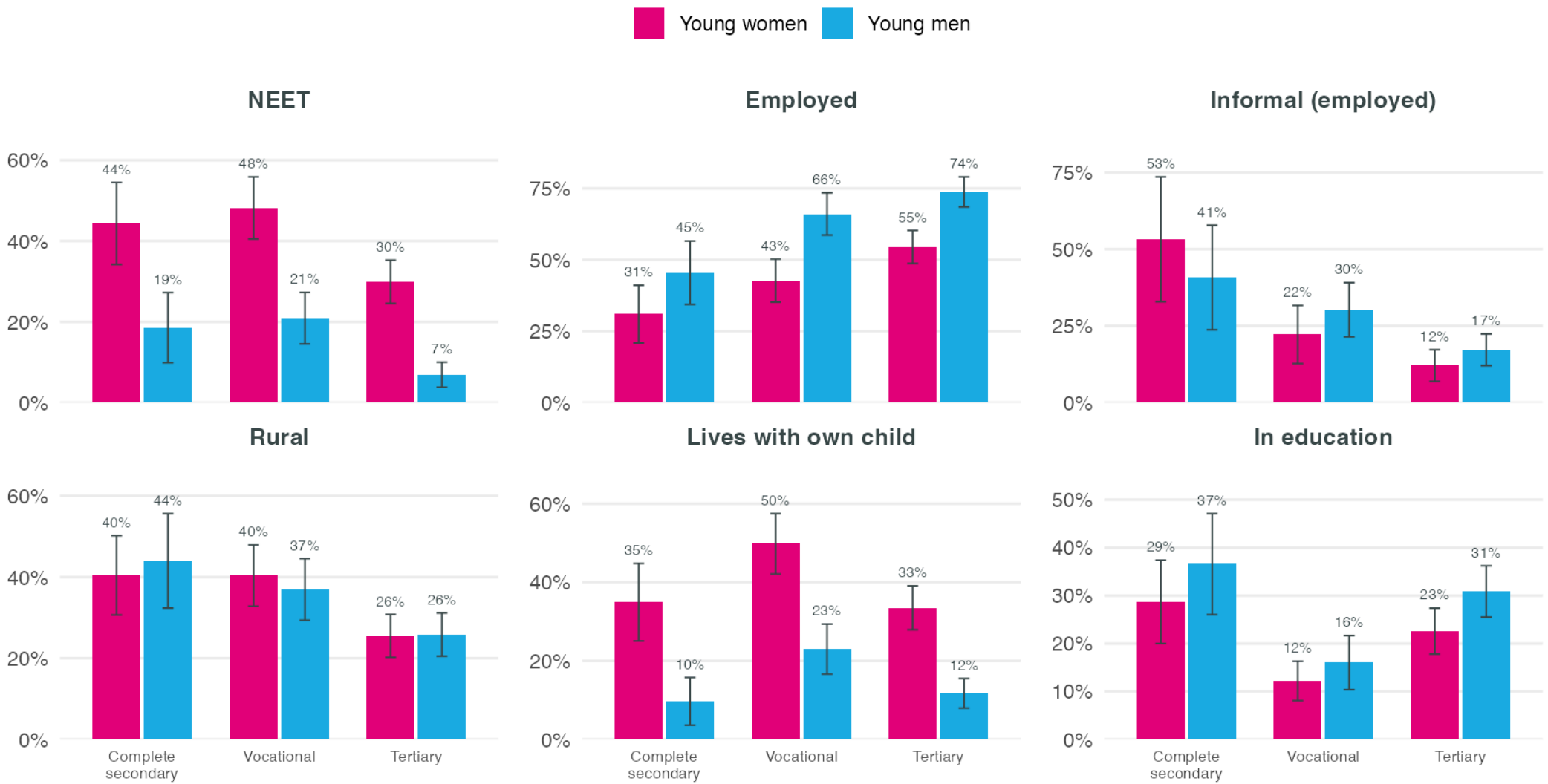
Moved: 12%. Lower income: 35%.

NEET and employment by education, women 18–24 (MICS)



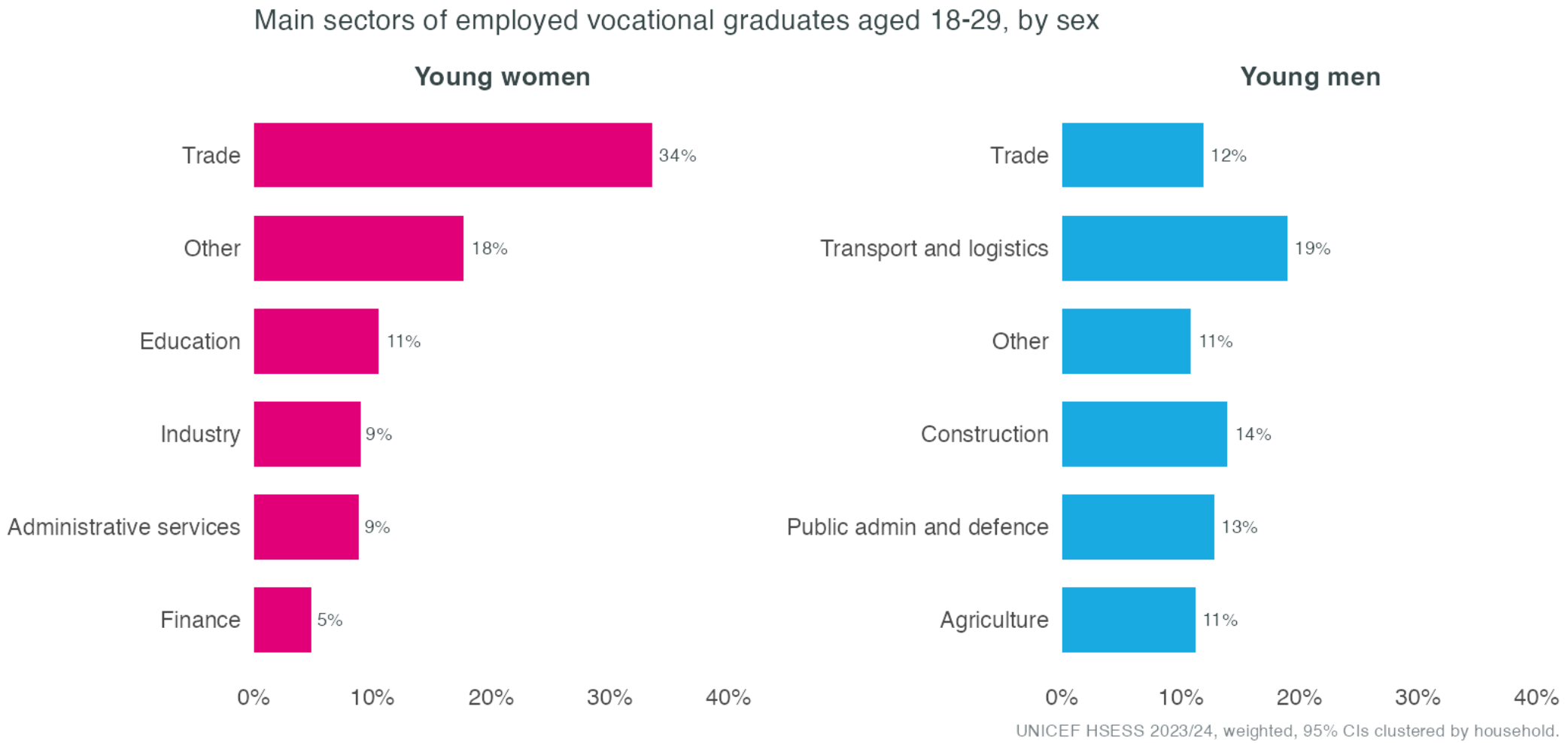
Vocational graduates aged 18–29: profile (HSESS)

People aged 18-29 by highest level of education and sex

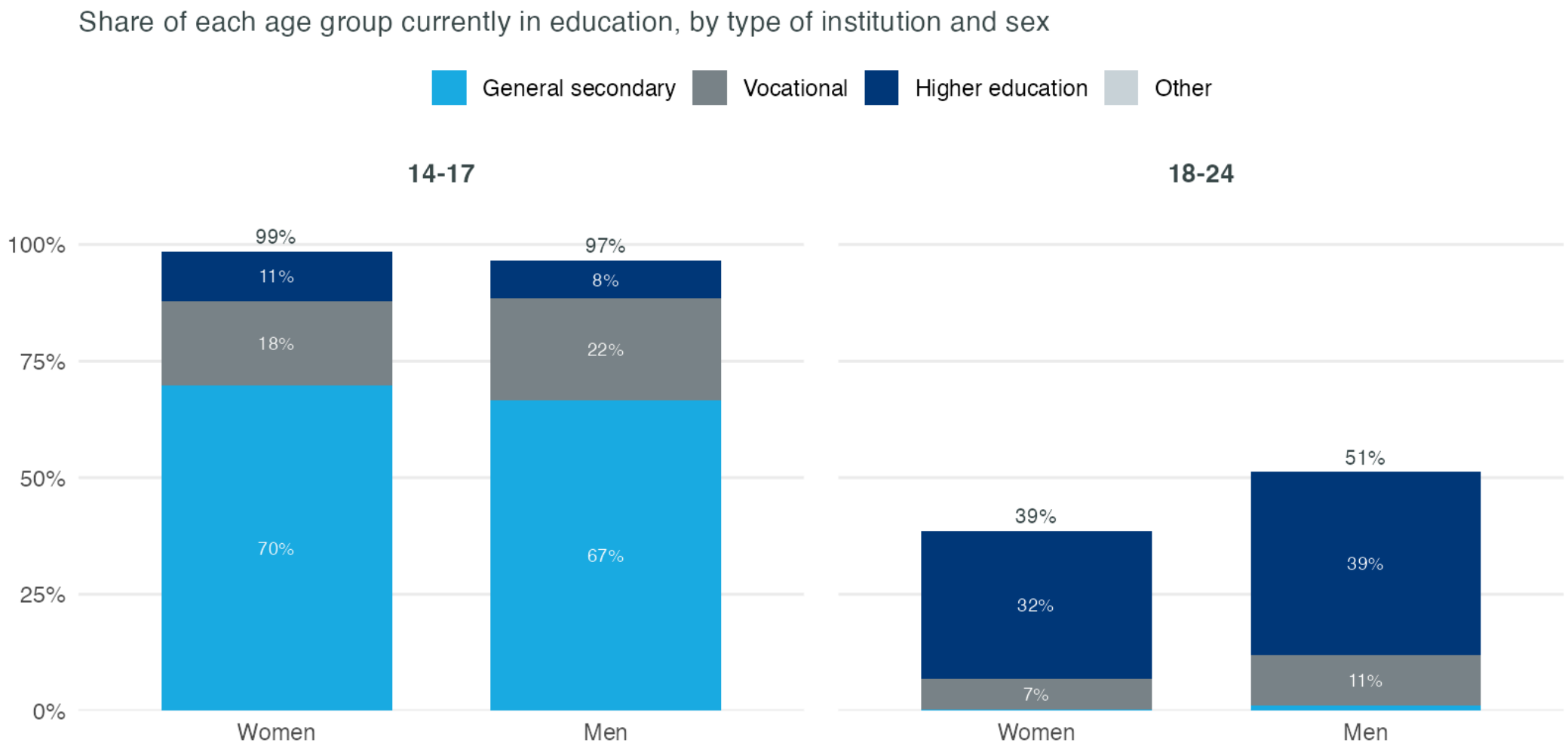


UNICEF HSESS 2023/24, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Sectors of employed vocational graduates aged 18–29 (HSESS)

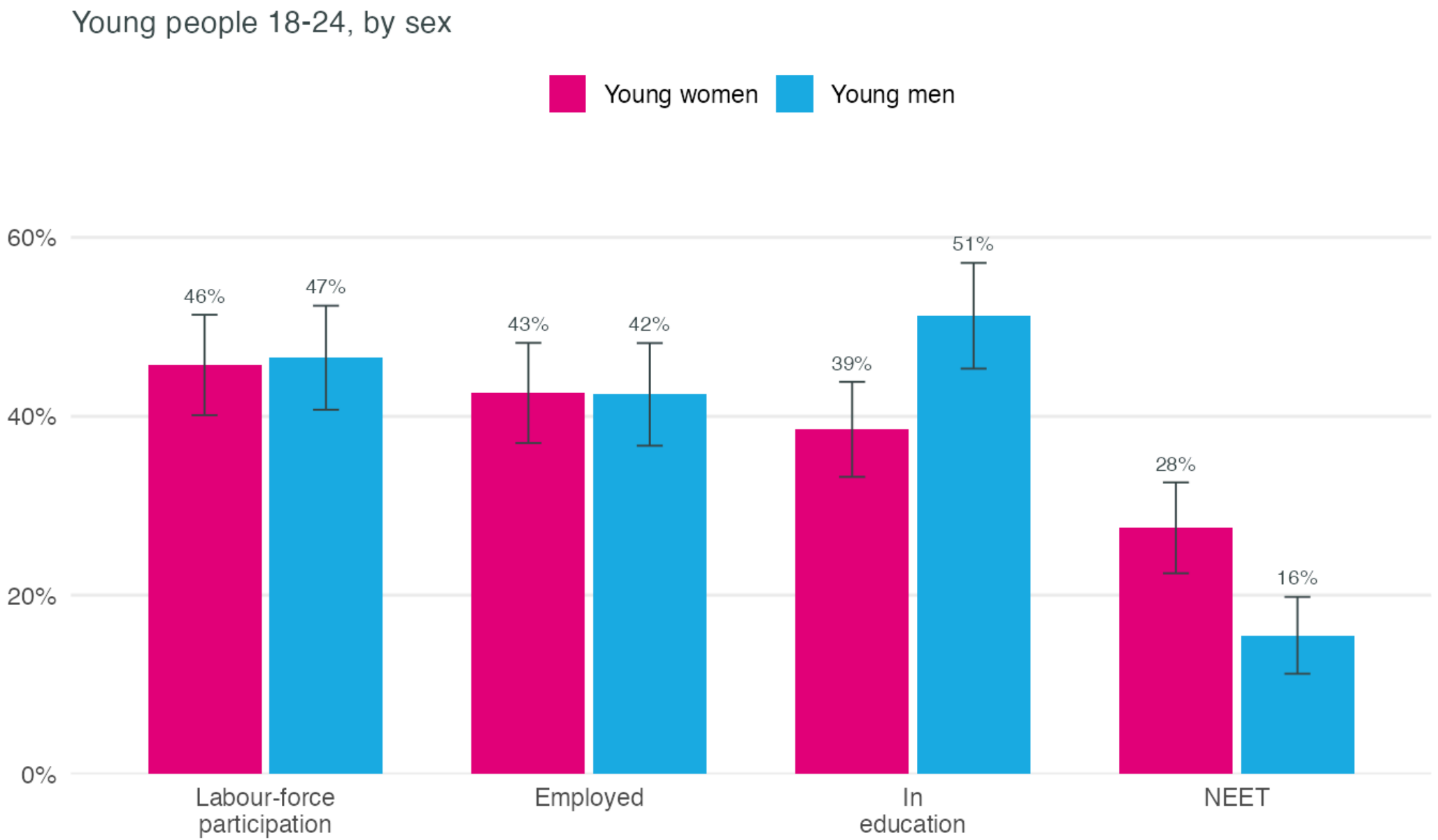


In education by type of institution (HSESS)



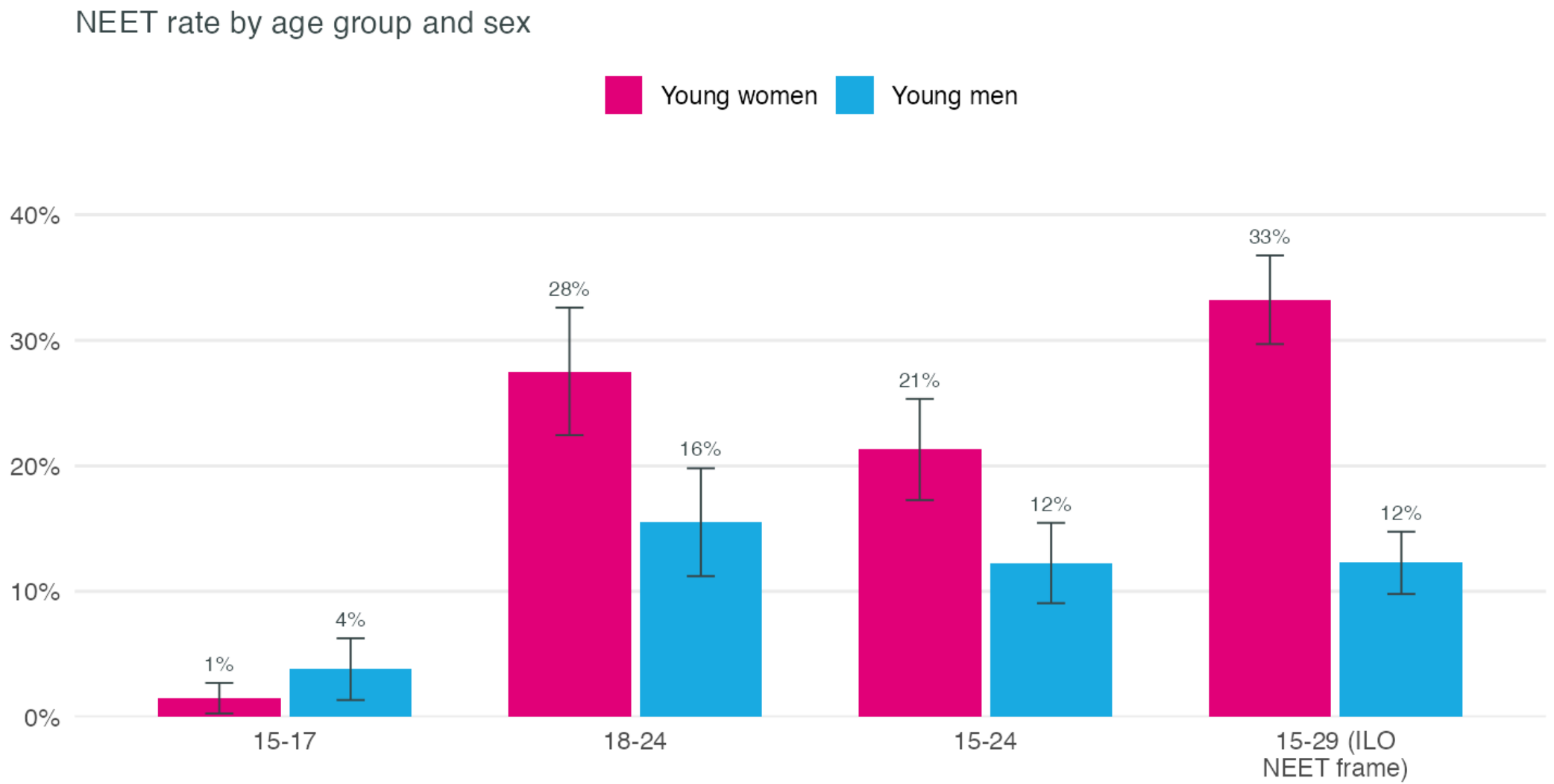
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Participation, employment, education and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



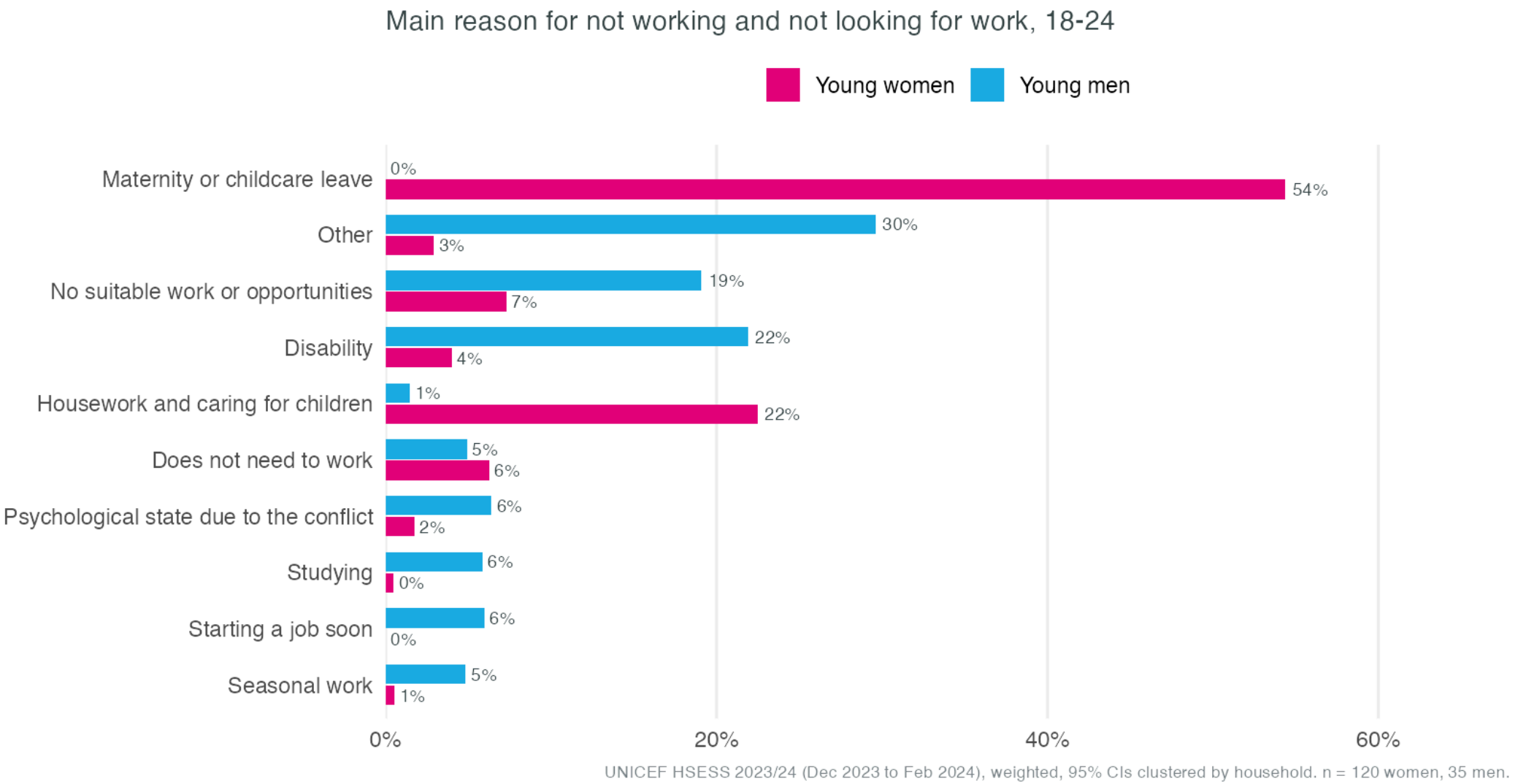
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

NEET by age group and sex (HSESS)



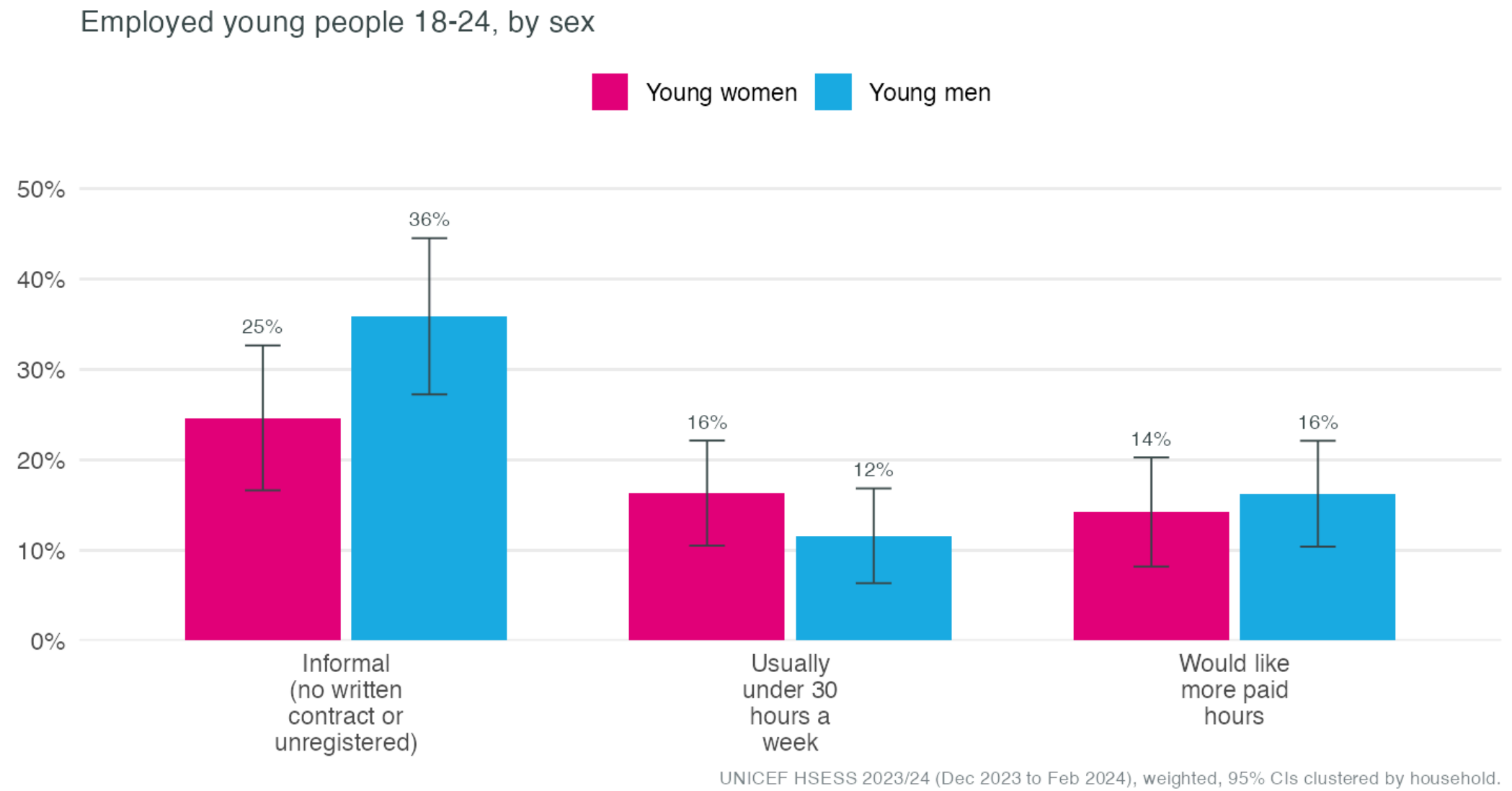
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Reasons for not working, detailed (HSESS)



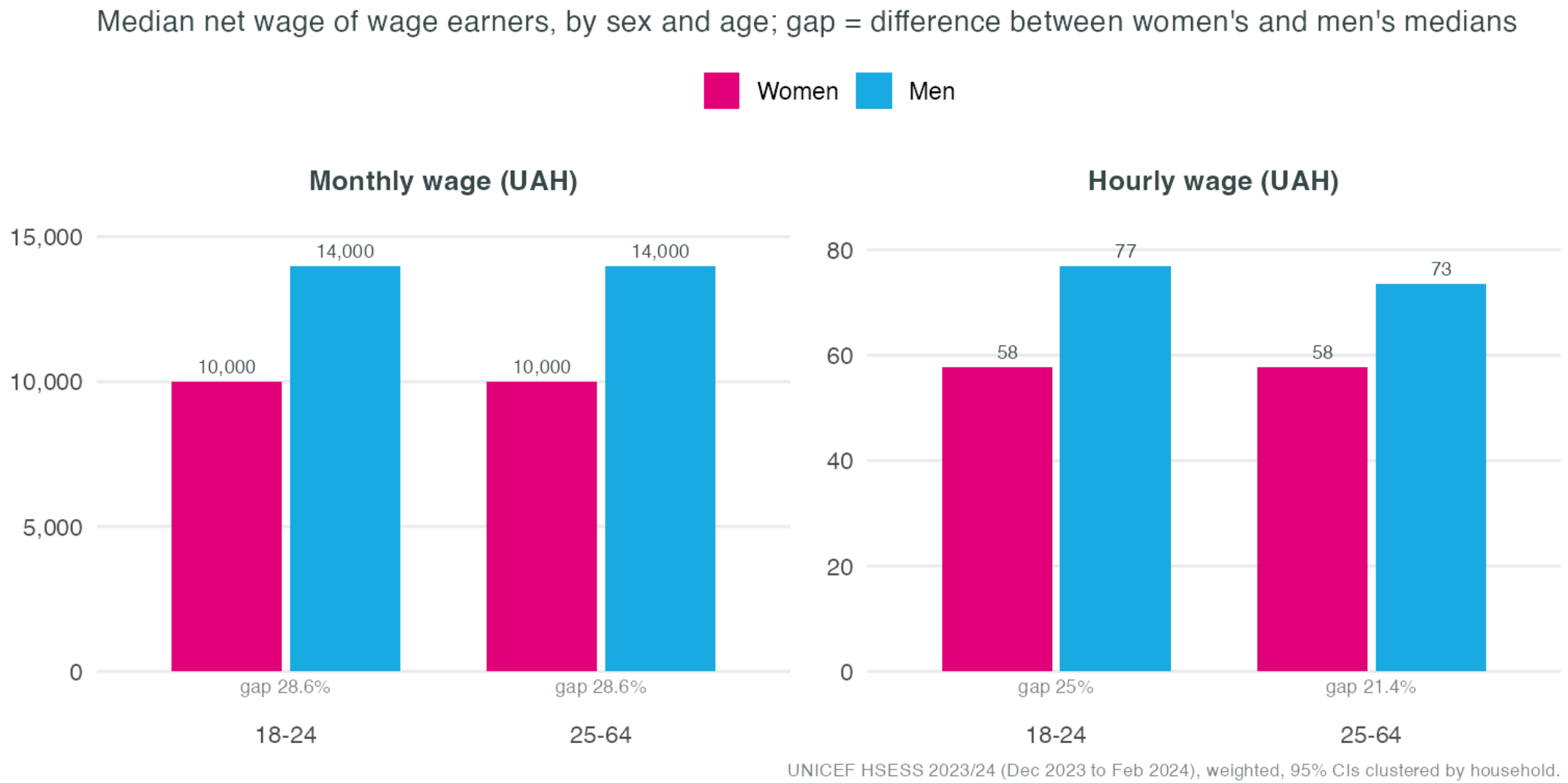
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household. n = 120 women, 35 men.

Informality, hours and wish for more hours at 18–24 (HSESS)



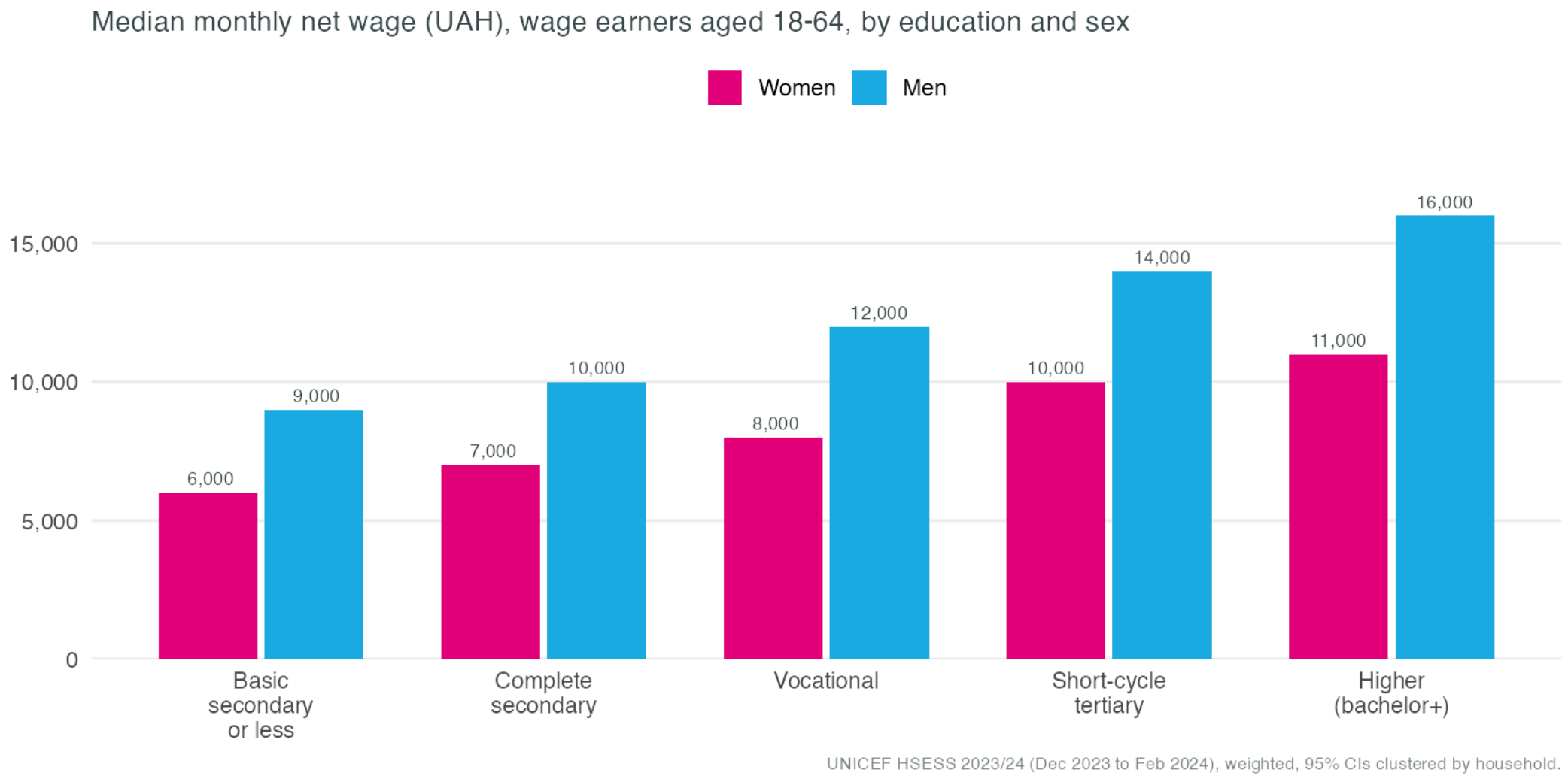
Informal: women 25%, men 36%.

Monthly and hourly wage gaps (HSESS)

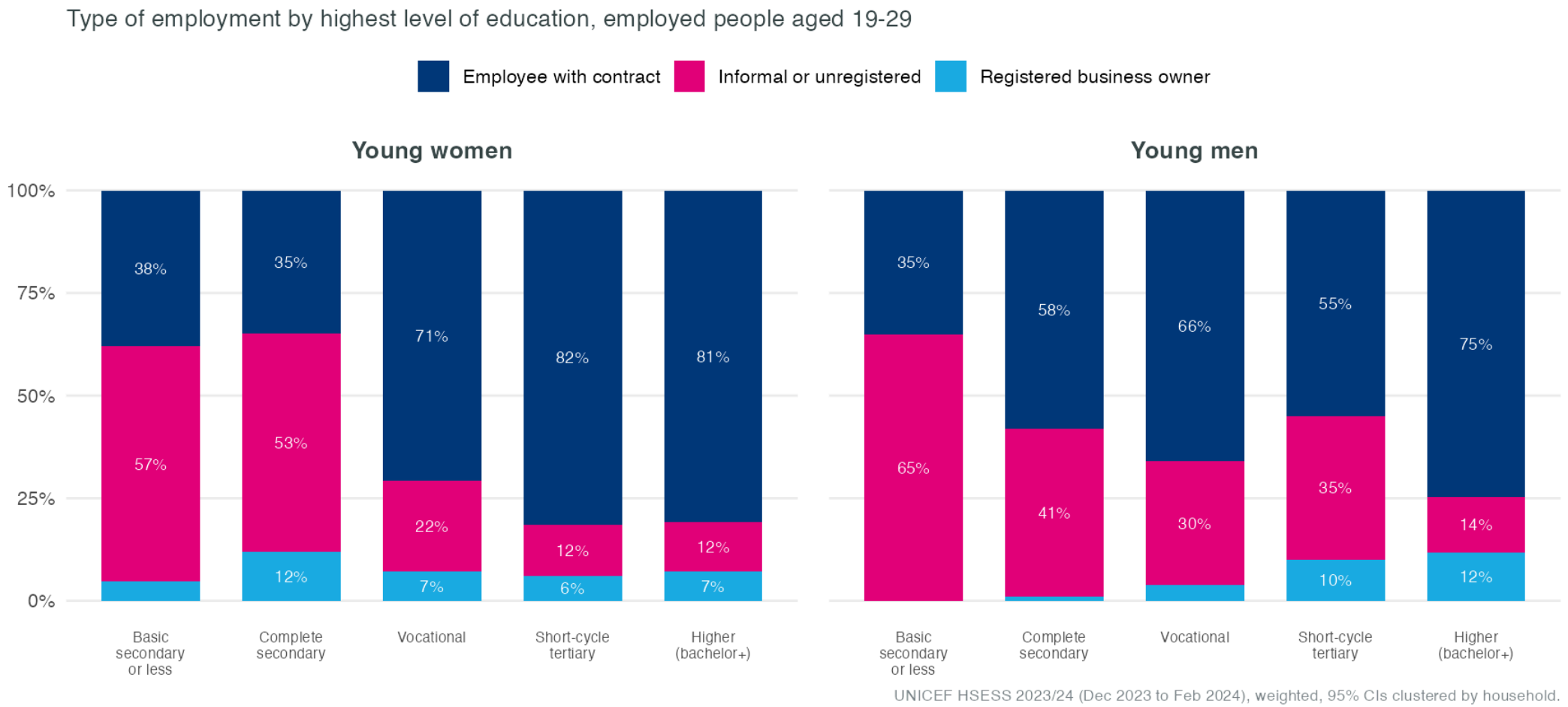


Hourly gap at 18–24: 25%.

Median wage by education and sex (HSESS)

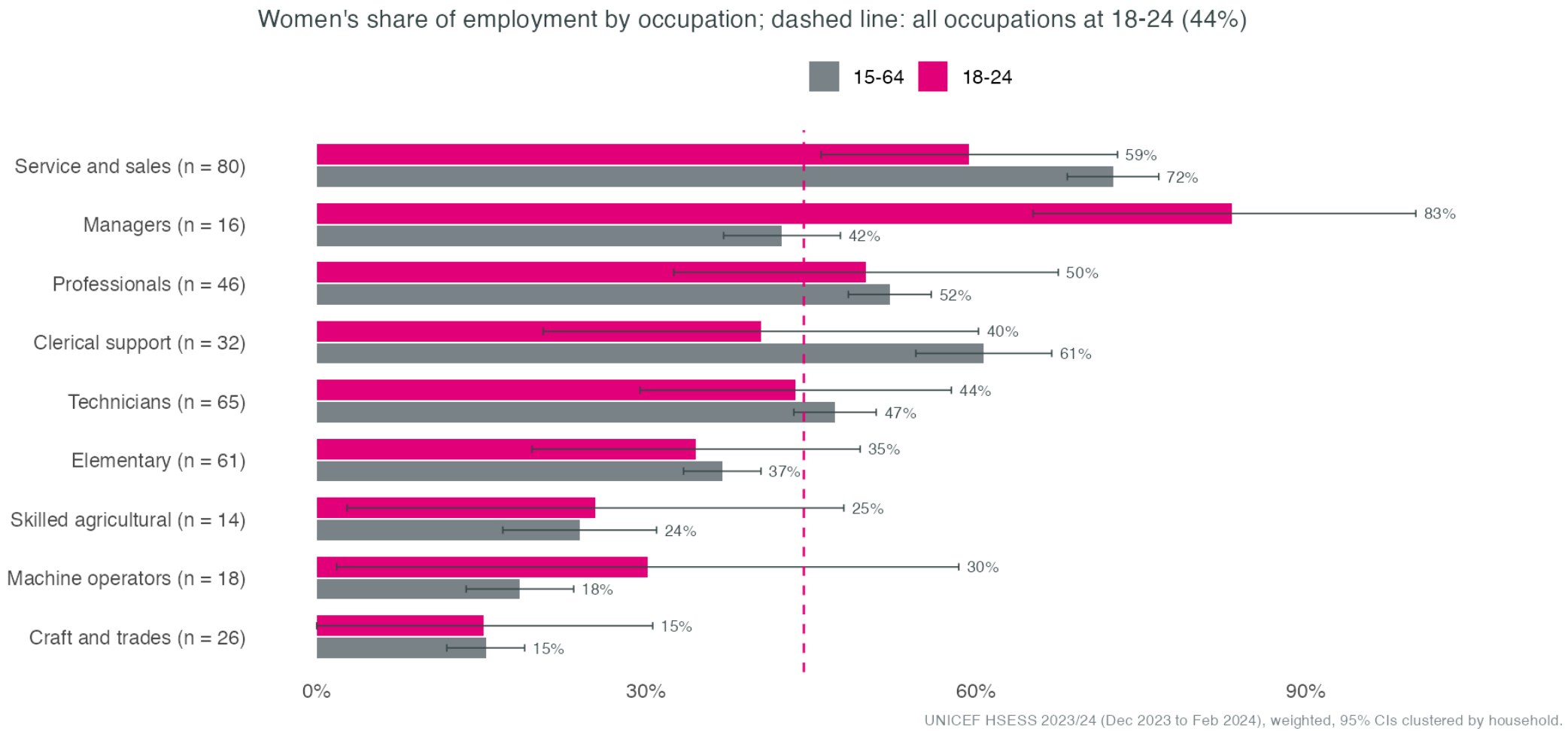


Type of employment by education, employed 18–29 (HSESS)



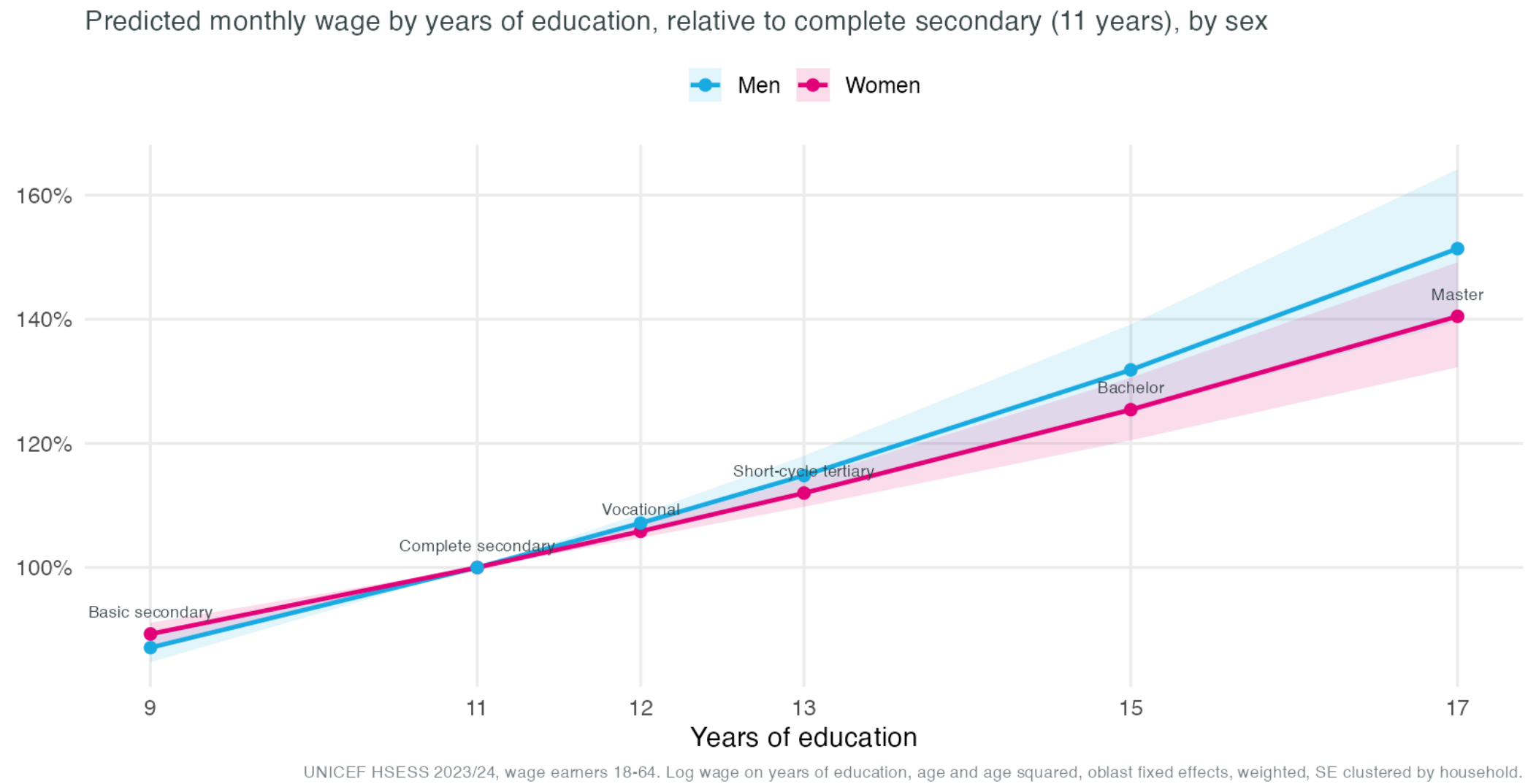
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Women’s share of employment by occupation (HSESS)



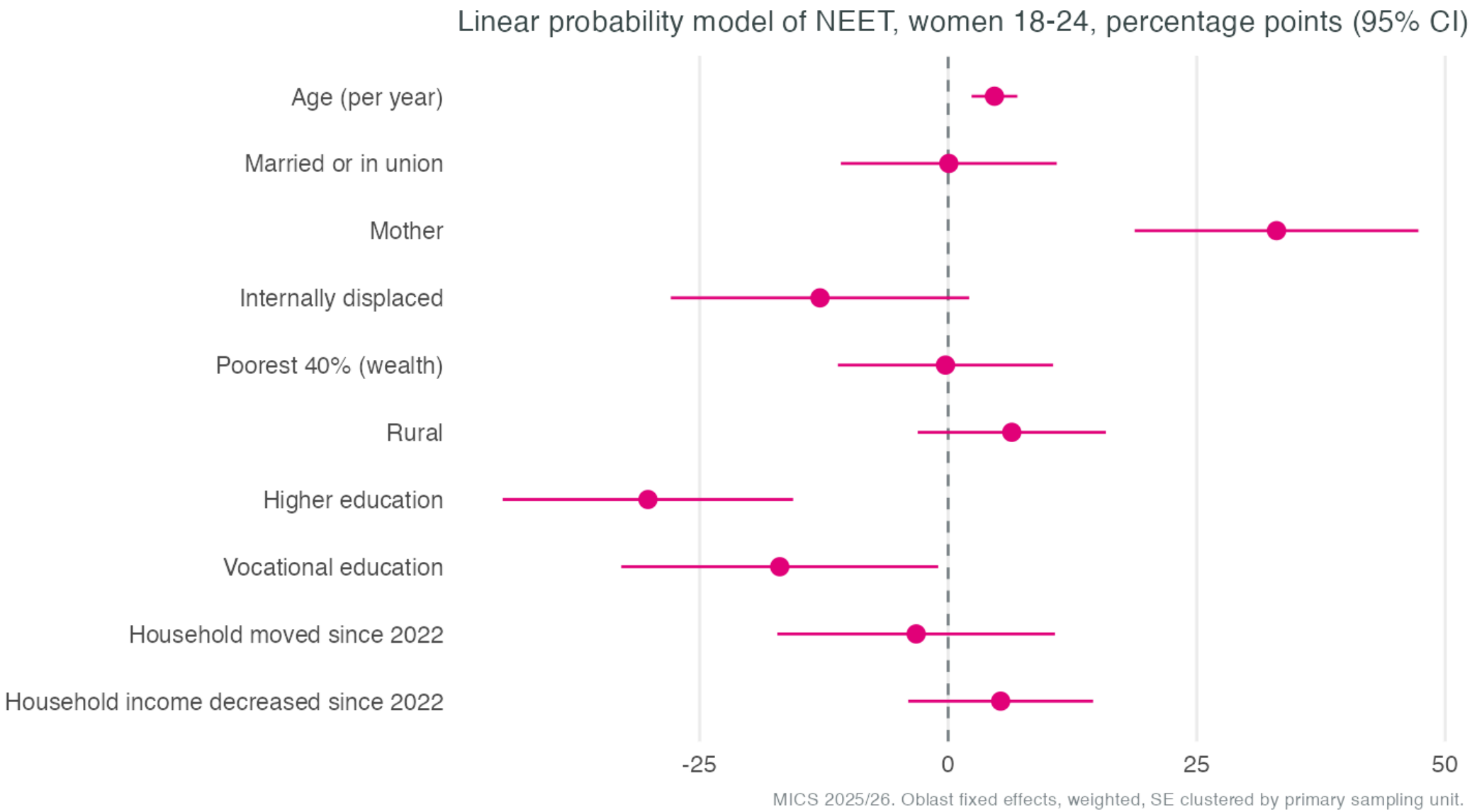
Occupation group as reported by the respondent; groups at 18–24 are small (n shown).

Wages and years of education (HSESS)

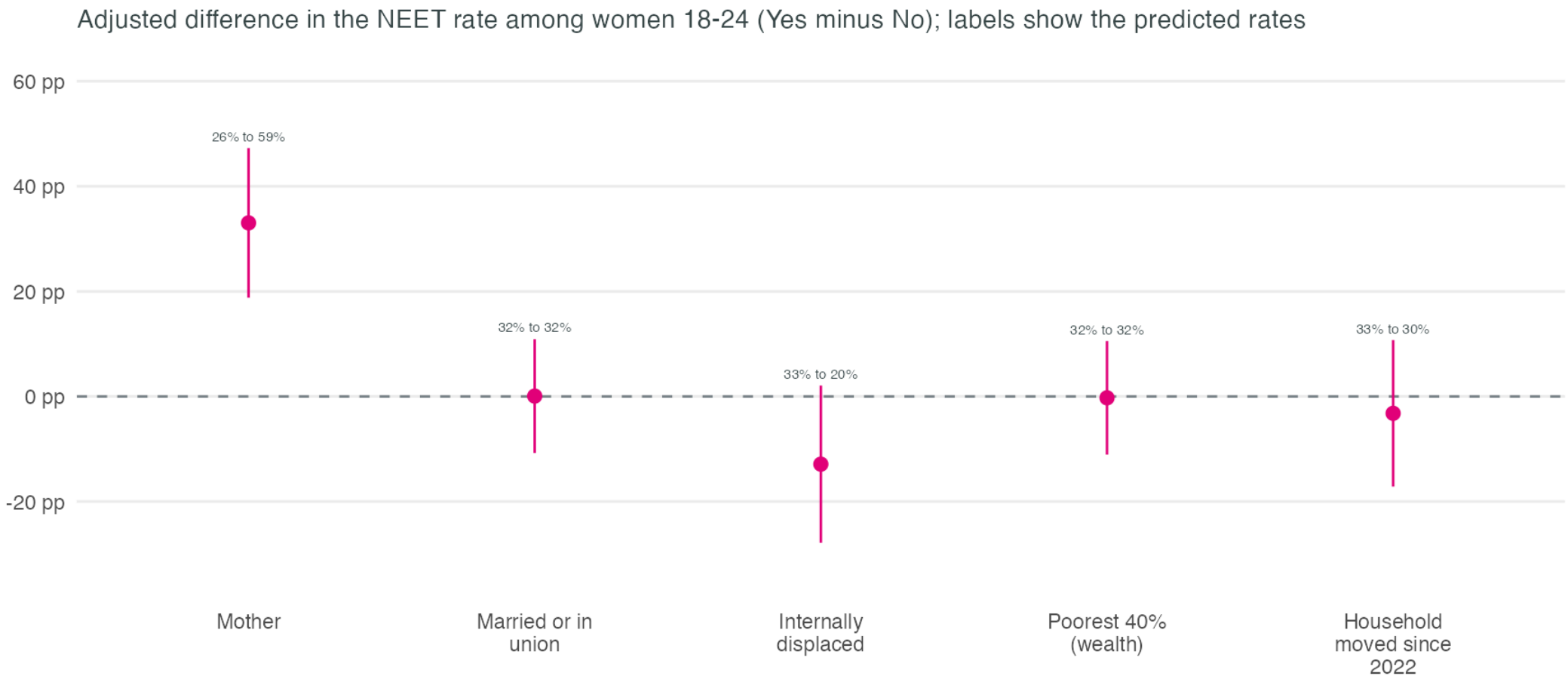


Return per additional year: women 5.8%, men 7.2%.

Model of NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)

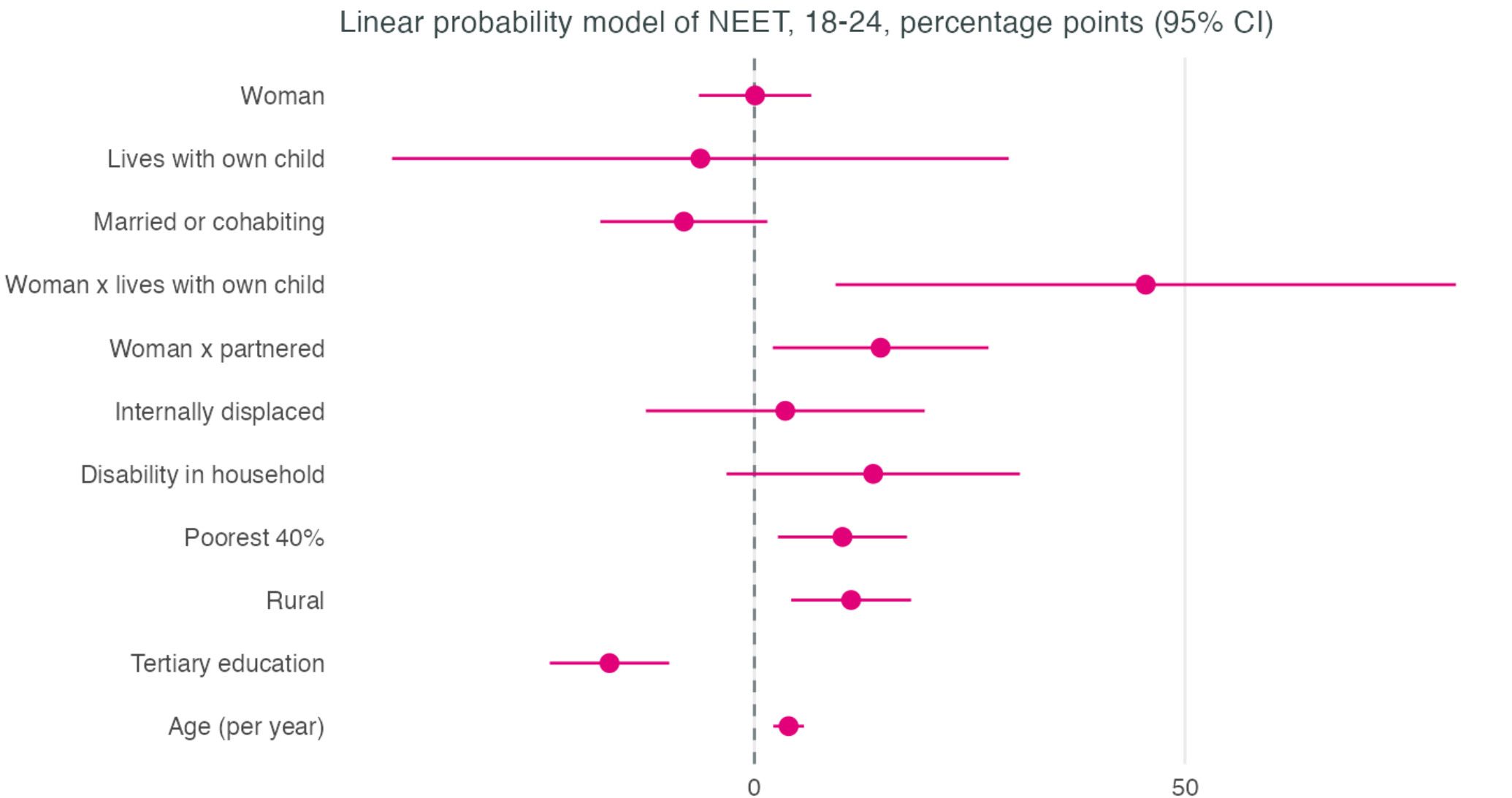


Adjusted differences in NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)



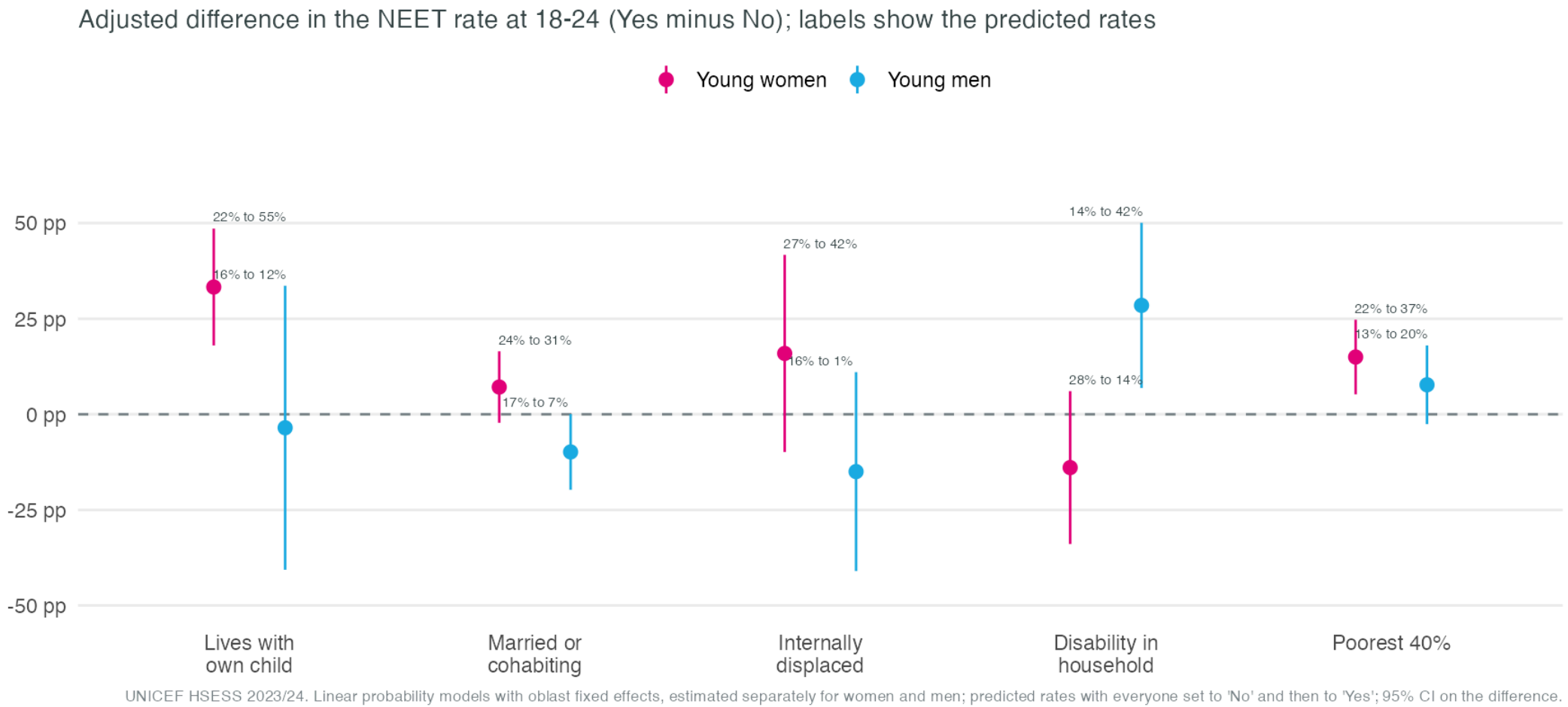
MICS 2025/26. Linear probability model with oblast fixed effects; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

Model of NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)

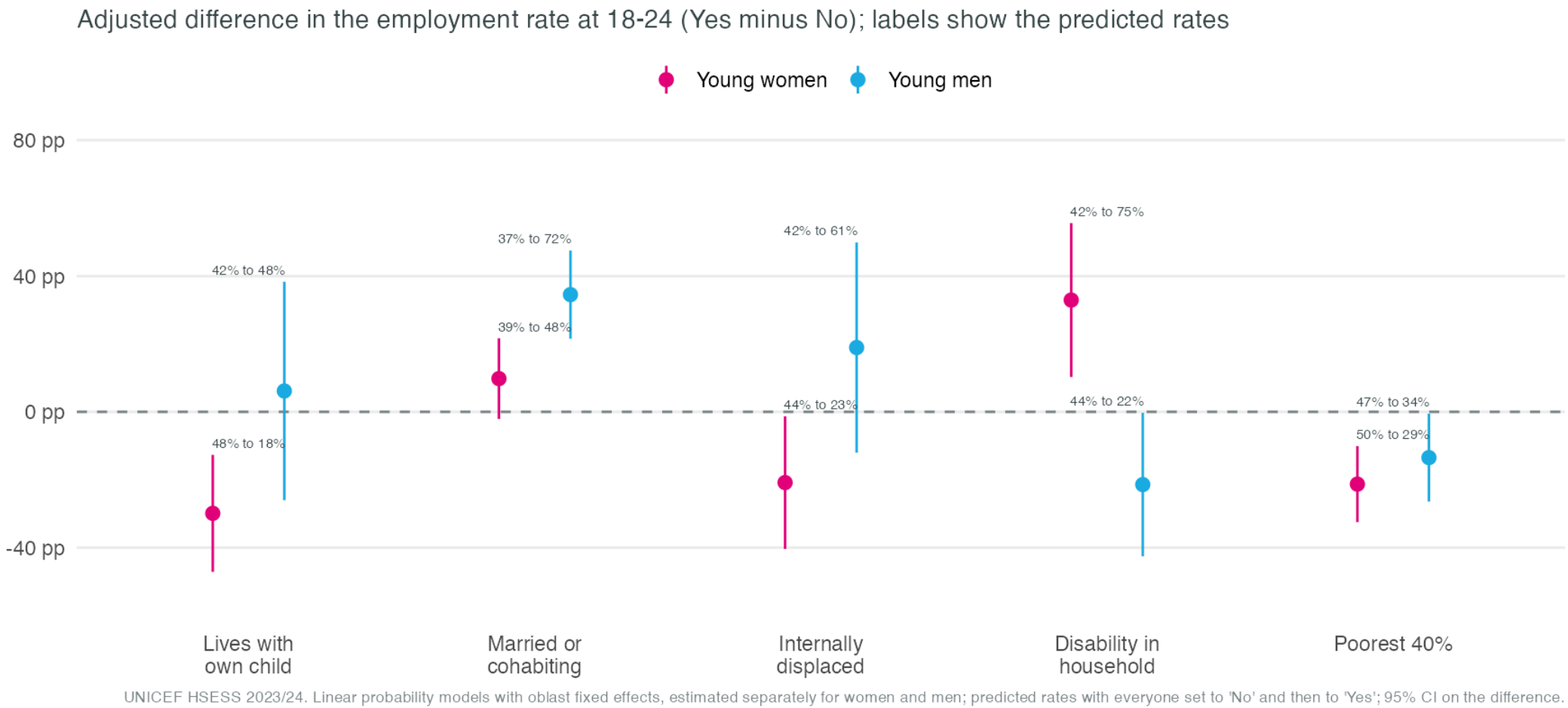


UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Oblast fixed effects, weighted, SE clustered by household.

Adjusted differences in NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



Adjusted differences in employment, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Linear probability models with oblast fixed effects, estimated separately for women and men; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

Estimates, MICS 2025/26

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: married or in union	Women 18-24	0.1	5.5	0.990	709
NEET: mother	Women 18-24	33.0	7.3	<0.001	709
NEET: married x mother	Women 18-24	11.2	12.9	0.390	709
NEET: internally displaced	Women 18-24	-12.9	7.6	0.092	709
NEET: poorest 40% (wealth)	Women 18-24	-0.3	5.5	0.960	709
NEET: rural	Women 18-24	6.4	4.8	0.180	709
NEET: household moved since 2022	Women 18-24	-3.2	7.1	0.650	709
NEET: household income decreased since 2022	Women 18-24	5.3	4.7	0.260	709
NEET: functional difficulty	Women 18-24	14.1	16.3	0.390	709

Effects in percentage points. Women aged 18–24. Controls: age, marital status, motherhood, displacement, poorest 40%, rural, education level, household moved and household income decreased since 2022, oblast fixed effects. Functional difficulty is estimated for women 18–24.

Estimates, HSESS 2023/24

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: women vs men	18-24	6.3	3.0	0.033	1084
NEET: woman x lives with own child	18-24	55.1	17.9	0.002	1084
NEET: woman x married or cohabiting	18-24	21.3	6.7	0.002	1084
NEET: internally displaced	18-24	5.2	8.4	0.530	1084
NEET: person with disability in household	18-24	13.5	9.2	0.140	1084
NEET: poorest 40% of households	18-24	8.9	3.9	0.021	1084
NEET: woman x poorest 40%	18-24	7.7	6.7	0.250	1084
NEET: rural	18-24	12.9	3.6	<0.001	1084

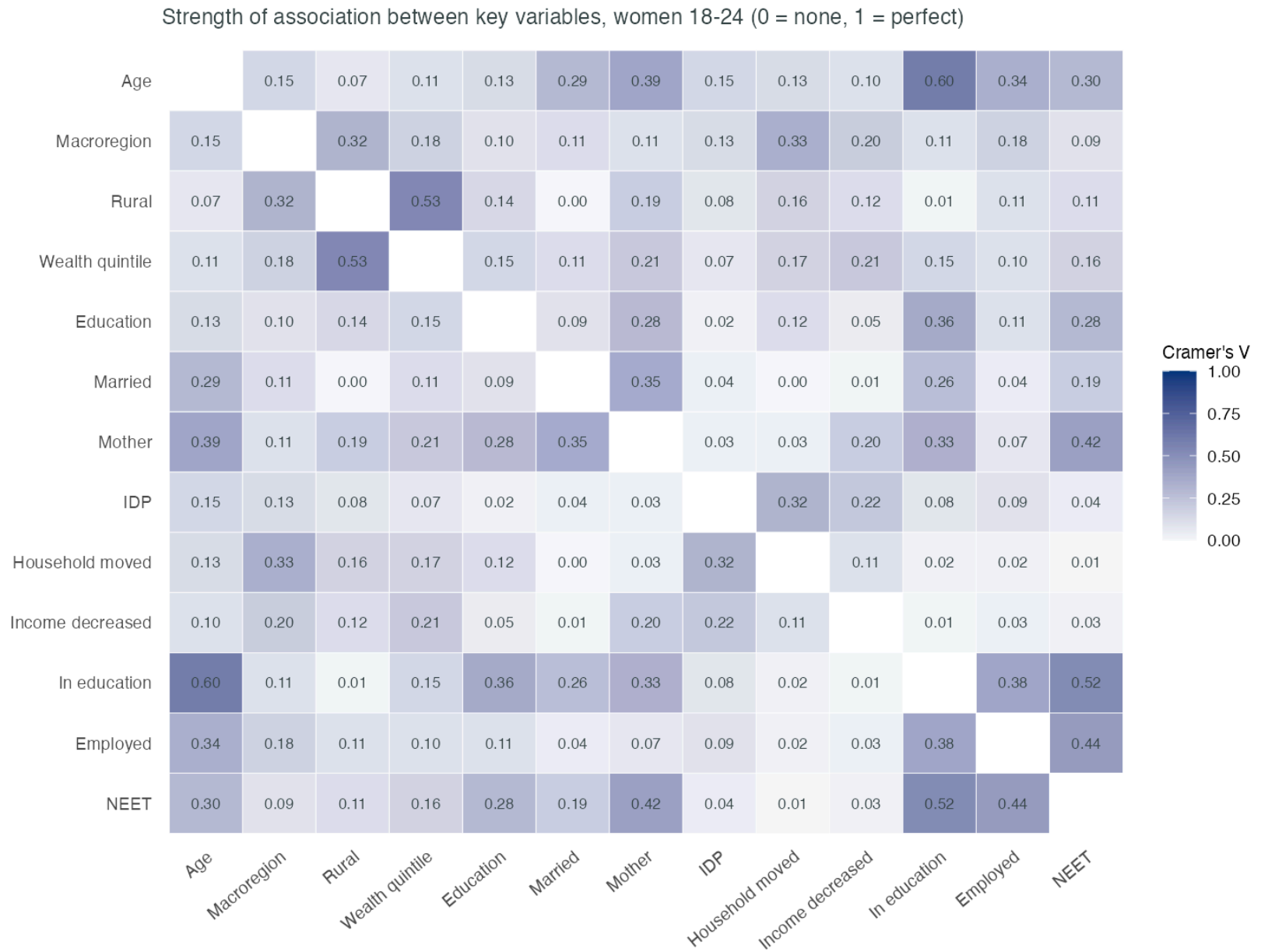
Effects in percentage points. Ages 18–24. Controls: age, rural, displacement, disability in household, poorest 40%, lives with own child, partnership and tertiary education (except where interacted), oblast fixed effects.

Returns to education, HSESS 2023/24

Sample	Return per year (%)	95% low	95% high	p	N
Women 18-64	5.8	4.8	6.9	<0.001	3112
Men 18-64	7.2	5.7	8.6	<0.001	2772
Difference women vs men (interaction)	-0.9	NA	NA	0.230	5884

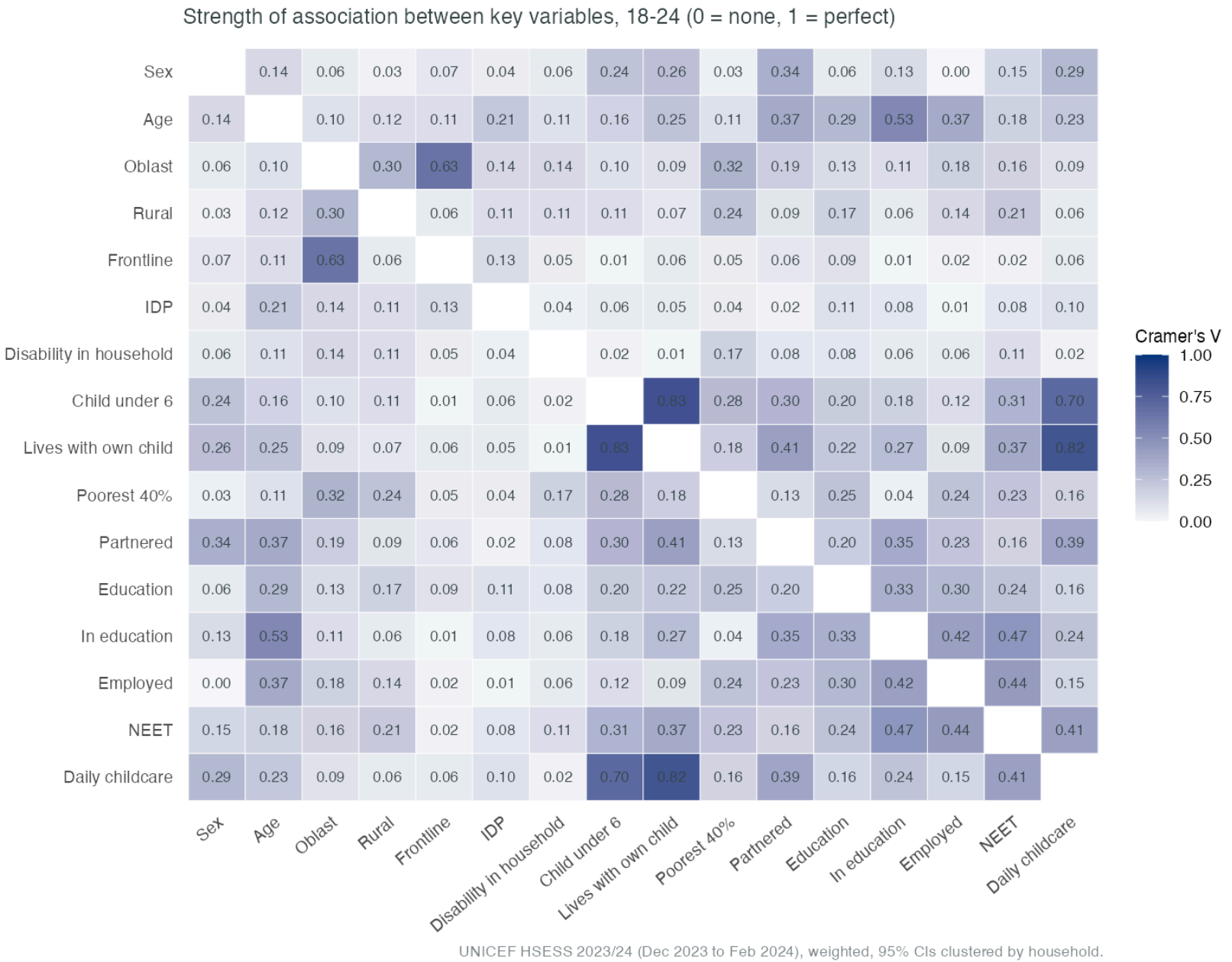
Log monthly net wage on years of education, age and age squared, oblast fixed effects, weighted, standard errors clustered by household. Wage earners aged 19–64.

Association between key variables, women 18–24 (MICS)



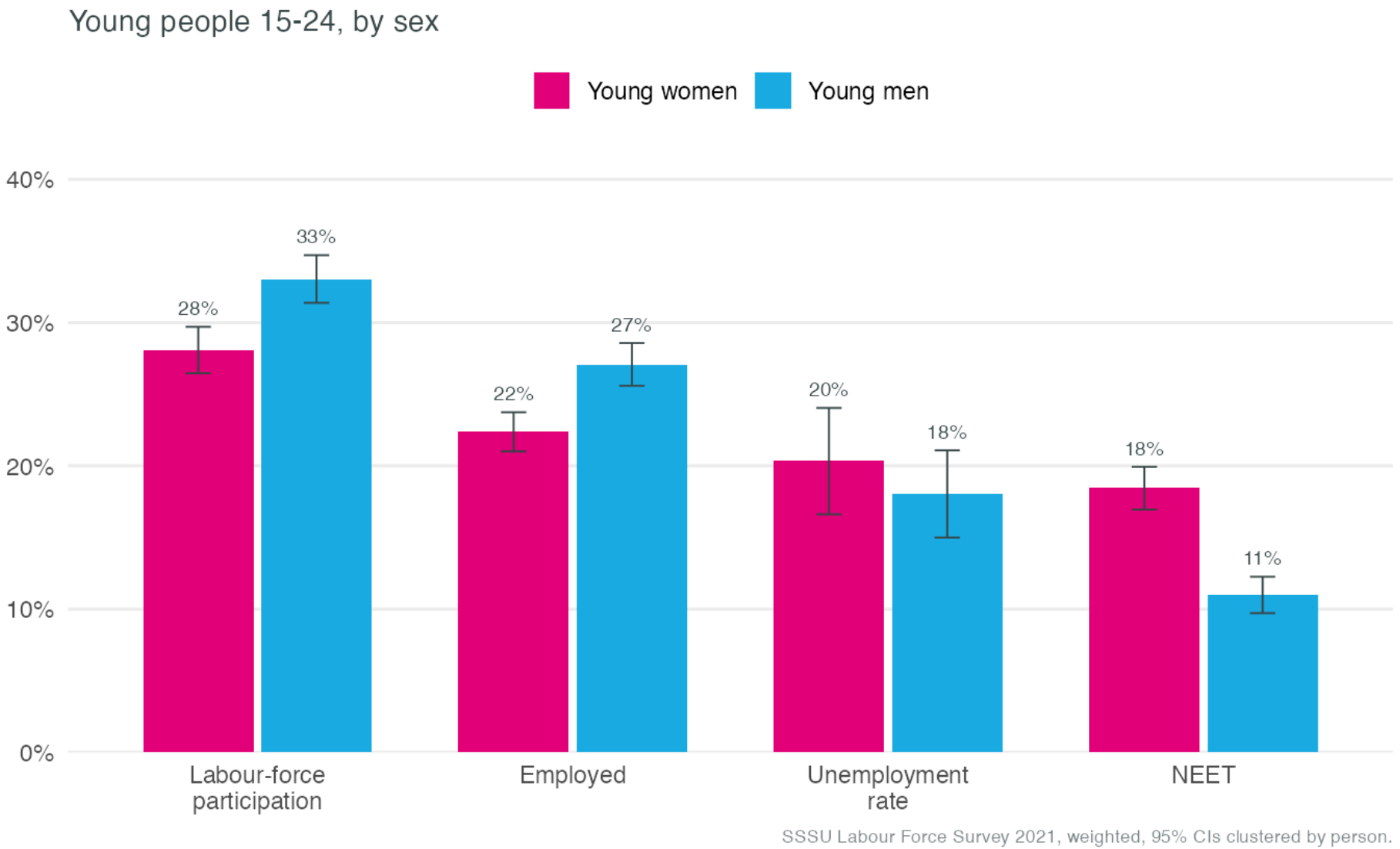
MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

Association between key variables, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



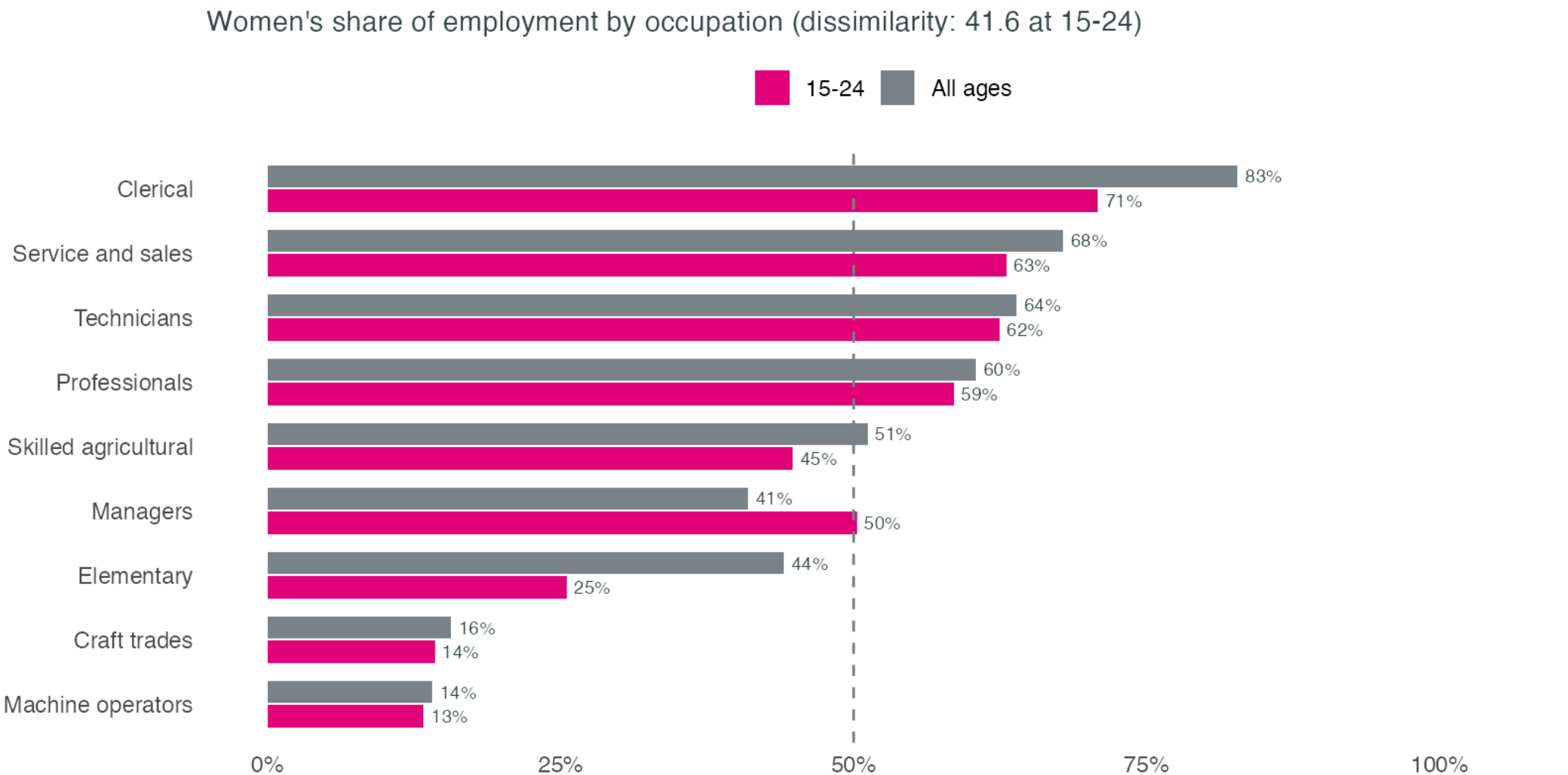
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: outcomes at 15–24 (age released only in bands)



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021. NEET: women 18%, men 11%. Age is released in bands, so 18–24 cannot be shown.

Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: occupations



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

HSESS variables used

Variable	Code	Variable	Code	Variable	Code
key (ind)	questionnaire key	econ_status (ind)	IND_B1	income_amount (ind)	IND_V1_1_1
weight (ind)	final weight	job_type (ind)	IND_B3_1	n_children (ind)	dity_n
oblast (ind)	OBLAST	sector (ind)	IND_B5_2	hh_size (ind)	hh_size
settlement (ind)	SETTL_TYPE	job_title (ind)	IND_B6_1	key (hh)	questionnaire key
relation (ind)	IND_A1	occupation (ind)	IND_B6_2	hh_income (hh)	V1
age (ind)	IND_A2	hours (ind)	IND_B9_1	disab_adult (hh)	D1_Mult3
sex (ind)	IND_A3	attitude (ind)	IND_B10_1	disab_child (hh)	D1_Mult4
marital (ind)	IND_A6	why_not_working (ind)	IND_B17_1	idp_hh (hh)	D1_Mult9
educ_level (ind)	IND_A7	seeking (ind)	IND_B21	veteran (hh)	D1_Mult10
in_educ (ind)	IND_A9	reason_inactive (ind)	IND_B24	lost_home (hh)	G3_5_1
institution (ind)	IND_A10	care_children (ind)	IND_B28_1	damaged_home (hh)	G3_5_2
preschool_reason (ind)	IND_A14	care_disabled (ind)	IND_B28_3	wealth (hh)	V16
moved (ind)	IND_A15	care_elderly (ind)	IND_B28_4		
idp (ind)	IND_A19	income_source (ind)	IND_V1_1		

Codes as in the questionnaire and the “variables_ukr” sheet of each HSESS file; “ind” = individual file, “hh” = household file.